WOMEN AS FINANCIAL ARCHITECTS: THE ROLE OF FEMALE HEADED HOUSEHOLDS IN OPTIMIZING FOREIGN REMITTANCE UTILISATION; A STUDY FROM SULTHAN BATHERY THALUK

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted to the University of Calicut in partial fulfilment of the requirement for the award of Master of Arts degree in Business Economics

Submitted By

FARHANA.M

Reg No: SMAYMBO004



Under the guidance of

NOORBINA K A

(Assistant Professor on Contract)

P.G DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS

ST. MARY'S COLLEGE, SULTHAN BATHERY.

2024-2026

P.G. DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS

ST. MARY'S COLLEGE, SULTHAN BATHERY

PIN: 673592

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project work entitled **"WOMEN AS FINANCIAL ARCHITECTS: THE ROLE OF FEMALE HEADED HOUSEHOLDS IN OPTIMIZING FOREIGN REMITTANCE UTILISATION; A STUDY FROM SULTHAN BATHERY THALUK"** submitted to Calicut University in partial fulfilment of the degree of Master of Arts in Business Economics is a record of the original work done by **FARHANA.M** under my supervision and guidance and that this project work has not formed on the basis for the award of any degree/ diploma/ fellowship or similar title to any candidate of any University.

Soumya T Joseph
Head of the Department
St. Mary's College
Sulthan Bathery

Noorbina K A
(Asst. Prof. on Contract)
St. Mary's College
Sulthan Bathery

Date:

Place: Sulthan Bathery

DECLARATION

As a part of my M.A. Business Economics CBCSS-PG project work **"WOMEN AS FINANCIAL ARCHITECTS: THE ROLE OF FEMALE HEADED HOUSEHOLDS IN OPTIMIZING FOREIGN REMITTANCE UTILISATION; A STUDY FROM SULTHAN BATHERY THALUK"** is a research work carried out by under the guidance of Mrs.Noorbina K.A, Assistant Professor on Contract in the department of Economics, St.Mary's College, Sulthan Bathery, Wayanad. I further declare that this project work has not formed on the basis of any other similarities associateship or awarded for any other degree. This project report is the result of my own efforts and original work**.**

FARHANA.M

Date:

Place: Sulthan Bathery

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I Would like to take the opportunity to express my sincere gratitude to all people who have helped me with sound advice and able guidance. While working on this dissertation a lot of people helped me to complete my study. First of all, I am grateful to God the Almighty, who is with me throughout my life.

I am deeply indebted to **Mrs. Noorbina K.A** the project guide, for his valuable guidance and encouragement throughout this project. I am also extending gratitude to other faculty members of the department.

I am thankful to **Dr. George Mathew,** Principal, St Mary's college Sulthan Bathery, for his permission and guidance to complete the study.

I wish to express my profound gratitude to **Mrs. Soumya T Joseph**, Head of the Department of Economics, and all other faculties in St Mary's College Sulthan Bathery.

I thank librarian of the college for helping me in searching books and journals.

I am also expressing my profound sense of gratitude to my parents and to all my classmates each and every one who have helped in the successful of completion of this project work.

FARHANA.M

CONTENTS

CHAPTERS	TITLE	PAGE NO.
I	**INTRODUCTION**	**1-17**
	1.1 INTRODUCTION	2-9
	1.2 SIGNIFICANCE OF THE STUDY	10
	1.3 STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM	11
	1.4 RESEARCH GAP	12
	1.5 OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY	13
	1.6 SCOPE OF THE STUDY	14
	1.7 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY OF THE STUDY	15
	1.9 LIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY	16
	CHAPTER FRAME	17
II	**REVIEW OF LITERATURE**	**18-24**
III	**PROFILE OF THE STUDY AREA**	**25-27**
IV	**DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION**	**28-65**
V	**FINDINGS, SUGGESTIONS AND CONCLUSION**	**66-71**
	BIBLIOGRAPHY	**72-74**
	APPENDIX	**75-80**

LIST OF TABLES

Table No:	Title	Page No:
4.1	Age composition of respondents	29
4.2	Annual amount of remittance	30
4.3	Region of remittance	31
4.4	Remittance income spent	32
4.5	Remittance for children's education	33
4.6	Remittance money for healthcare expenses	34
4.7	Remittance income saved	35
4.8	Income mainly saved	36
4.9	Remittance income in small business	37
4.10	Business or self-employment	38
4.11	Remittance for house construction or renovation	39
4.12	Debt repayment	40
4.13	Improvement in household consumption	41
4.13.1	Standard Deviation Calculation	41
4.14	Purchasing assets	42
4.15	Remittance for social functions	43
4.16	Remittance income utilization	44
4.17	Financial decision in household	45
4.18	Remittance expenditure by female head	46
4.19	Decision about house hold investment	47
4.20	Household savings management	48
4.21	Female head preparing household budget	49
4.22	Decision about children's education	50
4.23	Decision regarding borrowing	51
4.24	Decision on purchasing assets	52
4.25	Influence long term financial planning	53
4.26	Involvement in banking activities	54

4.27	Independent financial decision in emergencies	55
4.28	Financial decision role of female head	56
4.29	Standard of Living	57
4.30	Improvement in acces to better education	58
4.31	Improvement in healthcare access	59
4.32	Increased savings and financial security	60
4.33	Improvement in social status	61
4.34	New income generating opportunities	62
4.35	Reduced financial stress	63
4.36	Women's economic empowerment	64
4.37	Socio-economic impact of remittance	65

LIST OF FIGURES

Figure No.	Title	Page No.
4.1	Age Composition	29
4.2	Region of Remittance	31
4.3	Remittance Income Spent	32
4.4	Children's Education	33
4.5	Healthcare Expenses	34
4.6	Remittance Income Saved	35
4.7	Income Mainly Saved	36
4.8	Small Business	37
4.9	Business or Self-Employment	38
4.10	House Construction or Renovation	39
4.11	Debt Repayment	40
4.12	Purchasing Assets	42
4.13	Social Functions	43
4.14	Remittance Income Utilisation	44
4.15	Financial Decision	45
4.16	Remittance Expenditure	46
4.17	Household Investment	47
4.18	Savings Management	48
4.19	Household Budget	49
4.20	Decision on Education	50
4.21	Borrowing	51
4.22	Decision on Assets	52
4.23	Financial Planning	53
4.24	Banking Activities	54
4.25	Decision in Emergencies	55

4.26	Financial Decision Role	56
4.27	Standard of Living	57
4.28	Access to Education	58
4.29	Healthcare Access	59
4.30	Savings and Financial Security	60
4.31	Social Status	61
4.32	Income Generating Opportunities	62
4.33	Financial Stress	63
4.34	Women's Economic Empowerment	64
4.35	Socio-Economic Impact	65

LIST OF MAP

Map No.	Title	Page No.
3.1	Profile of the Study	27

CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction

Migration is the movement of people away from their usual place of residence to a new place of residence, either across an international border or within a State. Migration is a multidimensional phenomenon as it expands the opportunities for productive work and acts as an important livelihood strategy for various economically and socially poor groups across the globe. Numerous factors ranging from sociological and demographic such as race, ethnicity, education, household size and its composition, to political compulsions are responsible for human mobility internationally. Economic factors tend to play the most critical role in steering the individual's decision making- to migrate or not to migrate. A majority of economic migrants in the world move due to the lack of suitable employment opportunities at home and better economic incentives in destination countries (Khadria, 2009). The Global Commission on Migration (GCIM, 2005) has described the driving force in international migration in 3 Ds: Development, Demography and Democracy (Lakhwinder Singh et. Al. 2015).

Uneven capital inflow usually creates affluence as well as poverty. Hence movement of labour from subsistence sector to the developed capitalist sector and regions takes place. When labour movement is outside the country, it is international migration and when the labour moves within the country it is internal migration. Weather it is international or internal migration, it is mostly influenced by social structure, pattern of development, economic condition of the households etc. The developmental policies by of the government at the centre as well as the states, since independence, have accelerated the process of migration. Most particularly after the liberalization, privatization and globalization of the Indian economy the pace of migration has increased into manifold. In the recent years migration is considered as a major source of support to the migrating households. This is because the migrant workers send back a considerable part of their earnings to their family members at the place of their origin, which is identified as remittances have assumed great importance in the developmental process. This is due to the fact that remittances have the potential to create positive outcome in the remittance receiving households, as well as the community to which they belongs to. More particularly for the poor migrant households, remittances can help in eradication of

poverty by stimulating employment opportunities and diversification of income of the household (https://share.google/83k7TKzobchKCSpWS).

Migration and remittance has close relationship, it's a two sides of the coin. The migrants aim also like that in nourishment of family. However, the negative implication of the migration is the development. The recognition of migrant remittance enhanced the development of the country. So that remittance has the vital role of the country's development also migration is progressing everywhere. The flows of the remittances are increasing in the developing countries. This interest sharpened in remittance flows also development and eradicate poverty allegation in the affluent countries. Mostly, remittances considered as workers' wages in the form of sending money, gifts or donation in the country of origin. Rarely money acceptance also happens in the country of origin for the sustainability of migrants in the new country. As a part of migration, migrant aims are also be stable in the new country as well as acquire a job opportunity and earn something (Jo Joseph et al. 2023)

Many motives are there to remit money to the country of origin. It may hold assets, family flourish, save money for the future, education of the children and complexity of different kinds of socio economic factors. Supporting family is the main aim of the migrant remittance as part of their earnings as money or goods. In the world economy, remittances are the foreign currencies in the largest sources. Remittances can be made of various ways as money transfer by financial institutions such as banks, money transfer operators as Western Union, Moneygram etc. (Jo Joseph et al. 2023).

The impact of remittances highlights its advantages and demerits. First one is the eradication of poverty in the developing countries. In International remittance worldwide India is the largest recipient, over 80 billion in 2020 and migrants are over 15 million. Internal migration remittances are also there in India. The socio economic dimensions as regional, historical and analysis of international remittances in India as focused in this study. Primary aspects of this study includes as region of sources in migration, analysis and spatial variations of migration remittances in the geographical level. The analysis includes as Census, Reserve bank of India Notes, International surveys and interviews etc. (Jo Joseph et al. 2023).

The International migration from India mainly focused to the Middle East till the end of 20th century. In this migration majority are male dominated streams and remittance affected as 17% of Indian households. Generating substantial remittance of the source region and usually directed to the urban areas of Indian suburb. Mostly the migration happens in the small town cities to big town cities or rural urban etc. After the development of technology, social platforms are very useful to the information provider of migration process, job hunting, transportation and accommodation of migrants (Jo Joseph et al. 2023).

Gulf migration supports many households in India, the migration people builds a new face of Middle East in the modern era. Gulf remittance mainly supports the state of Kerala in India, savings remitted periodically sent to the origin country supports family, purchasing houses or land, investments, insurances, education and start a small business. Remittance service mechanism including postal money orders, bank drafts, cheques or wire transfers etc. Money transfer operators opened a new corridor of international or national remittances worldwide(Jo Joseph et al. 2023).

Later 20th century the international migration from India to Europe, Australia, US, Canada and New Zealand drastically increased. Non-resident Indians deposit accounts significantly grown in the 20th century. Also, development is also growing every aspects of human being. Majority of migrants are healthcare professionals from Indian suburb includes doctors and nurses, engineers, skilled professionals and unskilled migrants too. The recent trends are the healthcare professionals focusing on the United Kingdom. The reason is that UK liberated the rules and regulations, deficiency of healthcare professionals in the natives of UK, English as a foreign language, basic schooling onwards Indians are studies in English etc. These benefits are favoured many Indian nationality to compete with other nationality like Philippines, China, Africans etc. The authorities have employed foreign currency bonds for working Indians abroad as well as direct investment portfolios by the success of mobilizing the labour earnings through the financial account (Jo Joseph et al. 2023).

Migration barriers of the poorest people associated with costs and risks of the remittances. All needy populations are not accessible to the remittances and the migration, the initial capital needs to migrate. Since remittances are received periodically there's a motivation to create a culture dependency within the developments. The private sectors

of financial institutions are taking more interests in remittance rather than in the previous years. The private firms are competing to make customers as regular in the future then they makes many offers. Major banks are also providing best interest rates for non resident deposits. There's no doubt for closer cooperation of public and private sectors of remittance flows of sending and receiving countries, harness of potential development of the migration(Jo Joseph et al. 2023).

In an economic interest major portion of currency bonds re entered the country on redemption or inflows of current transfers of deposit schemes in India. Inflows of the current account without diminishing labour earnings of the financial account. This favoured migrant's remittances in legal channels. Workers remittances are recorded addition rather than substitution of earnings of labours. The source country operates through the remittances sent to home. The remittance receipts of households of non immigrant members upgrading living standards, healthcare accessibilities of future aid provisions. Therefore, the remittances are specifically in the development in the low and middle income countries of poverty considerable (Jo Joseph et al. 2023).

The impact of development starts with migrants remittances. "enveloping countries relies with the migrant remittances, some of the factors are affected to record the exact statistics of remittances in the past years. Economic restructures of the remittances reduces the chances of native worker employability, and international migration enabled significantly reduces the population of home countries. The greater significance of a short term development on the national efforts rather tented in the international migration for the welfare development. The impacts of large exodus in the national level or the international level, formation of human capital comprehend as higher proportional in the past several years. Despite of quite naturally trends or attracts of international migration and remittance for welfare development. The large Part of remittances is not recorded from the Middle East, growing unofficial remittances also growing in the gulf region in the past years. People are rely on the unofficial way to remit the remuneration with high exchange rates are often offered. The rotation of black money, conversion of black to become white happens in this way. Government is tightening the rules even though people are often used due to the high rate of exchange(Jo Joseph et al. 2023).

The Socio economic, demographic and political context of development in Indian states has to discuss in the modern era, in general context of vivid international migrations trends of Europe, UK, Canada, USA, Australia and New Zealand. The various economic developments of India and its states will account overall impact assessments of migration and its remittances. Migrant remittance policies are focus on the aspects of monetary but non pecuniary of remittance are important equally in the mode of migration. In the aspect of social remittance migration lead diffusion of cultural and social change. Social remittances as behaviour, identity and idea as a social capital of migration flow of sending and receiving countries This social capital has a major role in the migrant business start up's in the new country. This will affect the family formation, reunification and political integration etc. On the other side of a migrant remittance being cause of reducing the quality of states institutions also grows the corruption activities. Sending country has a tremendous option of rotating non residents funds for developments in each project (Jo Joseph et. Al 2023).

The increase of remittance will support government to do inappropriate activities, decisions and also it won't help for the people or the states. Many examples are in Indian states also corruptions too. Diaspora and migrants are become more active in the socio political, socio economic activities in the home country and it maintains a strong relationship vice versa. Developing countries are in demand with innovative mechanism of fostering grow of migrants because there is less people for low level works as agriculture, farming and construction etc. On the recipient of country along with several tax remittance as indirectly or directly. Mainly it happens in the currency exchanges as local to foreign currencies an additional tax must be remit it (Jo Joseph et. Al 2023).

Migrants' remitting behaviour is influenced by several factors, including, but not limited to, gender, age, education, marital status, and position in the family, as well as opportunities in the destination country. Though the importance of these factors is acknowledged in most studies, data are often not disaggregated by sex and other factors, and data from different countries sometimes show contradictory results https://share.google/sgoRxxYgAqMIZ2mkO.

At the global level, female migrants send approximately the same amount of remittances As male migrants. However, research suggests that women tend to send a higher

proportion of their income, even though they generally earn less than men. They also usually send money more regularly and for longer periods of time (IOM et al., 2007). By sending smaller sums more often, women tend to spend more on transfer fees. Therefore, reducing transfer fees and making different transfer options accessible would benefit these women and maximize the positive impact of remittances on their families and communities https://share.google/sgoRxxYgAqMIZ2mkO.

In general, men mostly remit to their wives, while female migrants often send remittances to the person (often a woman) taking care of her children (UN-INSTRAW, 2007), to ensure that the money is spent for the benefit of the children and the household (UN-INSTRAW, 2008a). Female migrants also tend to assume greater responsibility for money transfers to extended family members (Orozco et al., 2006). In patriarchal societies, when women marry, they frequently cease to send money to their own family, sending it instead to their husband's family (Piper, 2005).https://share.google/sgoRxxYgAqMIZ2m).

Kerala, one of the southern states of India, basically depending on migration for the last six decades. Kerala's foreign migration is around 2.1 million in 2018, which exhibited an upward trend and reached 2.2 million in 2023 (Rajan SI.,2024).Migration has improved Kerala at both the family and community levels. The socio-economic conditions of the state have considerably progressed due to migration (Azeez & Begum. M, 2009).Almost all the external migration in its earlier phases concentrated towards the middle-east, popularly known as Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) countries. Even today majority of the migrants targeted the gulf countries for their livelihood(Ministry of External Affairs, Gol. 2020).Historically, beginning of the large outflow of foreign migration, especially, towards GCC countries dates back to 1970s. The important driving force behind the mass outflow of employees were meagre domestic earnings, high domestic unemployment, stagnated domestic economy and comparatively better yields from abroad (Noushad, A. P et al.

2020)https://www.journalajeba.com/index.php/AJEBA/article/view/1824/4034.

Women in Kerala who receive remittances experience a complex mix of enhanced autonomy in certain private spheres (like healthcare decisions), but often face persistent new challenges in public life, including increased domestic responsibilities, social

restrictions, and, in some cases, limited control over major financial investments. Moreover, particularly this money which flows in Kerala makes a lot of differences among the households. Some of the houses the male will work in abroad and the female will take care of the house and children. While in some of the houses the female works abroad and the male will take care of the house and the children will be in boarding schools(Sancy K Jose et al 2022).

The remittance causes more implications in Kerala society. Hence, their spending patterns. Building houses, sending their children to good educational institutions, better health care, saving more in LICs, improving their travel expenses, and investing in various ways for the future. In common if we see the way the households spend, you can find massive differences among the men and women. Men will spend more in common. In general women are better at bargaining than men. The other indicator would be the women who always try to keep some money in their purses. They will not make it empty. But men will not bother about emptying their purses(Sancy K Jose et al 2022).

Various researches show a different opinion about the consumption expenditure pattern of the females in Kerala. In any research the output will be expected based on our assumptions. However, my research shows that in Kerala the female headed households are the most competent in the economic way of spending and savings while compared to the consumption expenditure pattern of male headed households(Sancy K Joseph et al 2022).

In Wayanad, as in the rest of Kerala, women in female-headed families play a central and empowered role in managing remittances, which are a critical source of household income. While specific, localized studies for Wayanad are limited in the provided sources, general trends across Kerala indicate significant details .

Women in these households are the primary decision-makers for day-to-day cash flow and the overall use of remittances. Remittances are largely directed towards essential family needs, including children's education, healthcare, food, and clothing. This focus significantly improves the socio-economic status and living standards of the family.

In cases where the male head has migrated, the woman left behind acts as a "proxy manager," having significant say in how funds are distributed, often reflecting the

migrant's intentions. Single or divorced female migrants often send money to their mothers, who manage the funds. Beyond money, women also manage "social remittances" – new norms, ideas, and social capital gained from exposure to different cultures through migration channels. This can erode traditional power relations and enhance their autonomy and decision-making capabilities within the household.

In Kerala, especially in districts like Wayanad and Sulthan Bathery Taluk , women in remittancereceiving households play a key role in managing and utilizing the funds sent from abroad. It primary focus on household consumption and basic needs, coupled with significant investment in education, healthcare, and housing/land acquisition, with specific saving behaviours often influenced by the regularity of the remittances and their control over the funds.

A significant portion of remittances is allocated to daily consumption, including food, clothing, and utilities, which helps improve the overall standard of living for the family left behind. A major chunk of the funds is spent on human capital formation, specifically children's education and family healthcare, which are considered crucial investments for future well-being. The availability of regular remittances is linked to women having more autonomy in making healthcare decisions.

Remittance-receiving households often upgrade their living conditions by building or renovating houses and acquiring consumer durables, which are seen as status-enhancing goods. Women are conscious of their future and save a portion of the remittance by keeping them in bank accounts or purchasing insurance and investment bonds. However, local bank enquiries in general studies revealed that while remittances lead to overall higher income, significant fixed deposits specifically from these households were not always prominent, suggesting other forms of investment.

1.2 Significance of the Study

This study is significant as it focuses on the role of women in managing and utilizing foreign remittances in female-headed households. It helps to understand how remittance income is used for meeting household expenses, savings, education, healthcare, and other essential needs. By highlighting women's financial decisions, the study shows their contribution to improving the economic condition of the household.

The study is also useful for policymakers and financial institutions in designing programmes related to women empowerment and financial inclusion. It adds to existing research on remittances and gender roles and provides a base for future studies on remittance utilization in female-headed households.

1.3 Statement of the Problem

Kerala's economy is heavily influenced by foreign remittances, which serve as a vital source of income and development for many households, particularly in regions like Sulthan Bathery Taluk of Wayanad district. With the increase in male migration, many households have become femaleheaded, placing women in charge of managing remittance inflows and household finances. This shift has redefined women's roles within the family and community, positioning them as key financial decision-makers. However, despite their growing involvement in handling remittance income, there is limited understanding of how effectively these women utilise the funds for longterm welfare, savings, and investment purposes.

The core issue lies in assessing whether female-headed households are able to optimise remittance utilisation beyond basic consumption to achieve sustainable economic empowerment. Factors such as financial literacy, access to banking facilities, social constraints, and autonomy in decisionmaking significantly shape women's ability to act as financial architects within their families. In the specific socio-cultural context of Sulthan Bathery, it becomes crucial to examine how women allocate remittance income and what challenges they face in transforming these inflows into productive assets. Thus, the study seeks to understand the patterns, determinants, and implications of remittance management among female-headed households, highlighting women's evolving financial role in remittance-dependent communities of Kerala.

1.4 Research Gap

Although several studies have examined the economic impact of foreign remittances on household welfare, limited attention has been given to the role of female-headed households in managing and optimizing these funds. Existing research mainly focuses on income, consumption, and poverty reduction, while women's financial decision-making, savings behavior, and investment choices remain underexplored. Additionally, there is insufficient evidence on the challenges faced by women in utilizing remittances effectively and their contribution to long-term household financial stability. Therefore, this study seeks to fill this gap by examining how female-headed households optimize foreign remittance utilization to improve household welfare and economic well-being.

1.5 Objectives of the study

- To study how female-headed households use foreign remittance money.
- To understand the role of women in making financial decisions at home.
- To examine the socio economic impact of remittance utilisation on the family welfare and asset creation.

1.6 Scope of the Study

The present study focuses on understanding the role of women in female-headed households in managing and optimising foreign remittance income, with specific reference to Sulthan Bathery Taluk in Wayanad district, Kerala. The study seeks to examine how women, as primary financial decision-makers, allocate remittance inflows toward various household needs such as consumption, education, healthcare, savings, investment, and debt repayment. It also aims to identify the factors influencing their financial decisions, including their level of financial literacy, access to banking and credit services, social support networks, and degree of economic autonomy.

The research is confined geographically to Sulthan Bathery Taluk, chosen for its significant share of remittance-dependent families and rising number of female-headed households. The study period and analysis are limited to current remittance practices and their socio-economic impacts at the household level. It does not focus on remittance outflows, migration dynamics, or maleheaded households except for comparative understanding where necessary. The findings are intended to contribute to a broader understanding of gendered financial behaviour and to highlight how empowering women in remittance-receiving households can strengthen community development and economic sustainability in Kerala.

1.8 Research Methodology of the study

Sample

Sampling is the process of selection of units from a population interest so that by studying the sample may fairly generate results back to the population from which they were chosen. The present study is based on the sample of 60 women headed households. Out of these, all women headed households data were fully filled by them through directly and google form. The data were collected from the women headed households of Sulthan Bathery Thaluk in Wayanad district. This study is mainly concentrated on women who make crucial decision in managing remittances.

Sampling techniques

Random sampling techniques were used to select samples from Sulthan Bathery Thaluk in Wayanad. Random sampling is a sampling technique in which all elements have an equal chance of the being selected. I selected samples from Sulthan Bathery Thaluk in Wayanad.

Methodology

The study is based on primary data which was collected through small questionnaires and secondary data. The data were collected specially designed google form and questionnaire.

1.9 Limitations of the Study

1. The study is limited to a specific area, so the findings cannot be generalized to other regions.
2. The sample size is small due to time and resource constraints.
3. The study depends on respondents' answers, which may involve personal bias or inaccurate information.
4. Remittance income is not regular and may vary over time, affecting the analysis.
5. The study focuses only on female-headed households and does not include comparison with male-headed households.

Chapter Frame

The research work titled “Women as Financial Architects: The Role of Female-Headed Households in Optimizing Foreign Remittance Utilisation: A Study of Sulthan Bathery Taluk” is divided into five chapters.

The first chapter deals with the introduction of the study. It includes the background of the study, statement of the problem, research gap, significance of the study, objectives of the study, research methodology, scope of the study, limitations of the study, and chapter frame.

The second chapter presents a review of the literature related to foreign remittances, female-headed households, women's role in household financial management, and the utilisation of foreign remittances. It also reviews the findings of previous studies collected from books, journals, reports, and online sources.

The third chapter provides an overview of the study area, namely Sulthan Bathery Taluk, describing its geographical, demographic, and socio-economic characteristics relevant to the study.

The fourth chapter includes the presentation, analysis, and interpretation of the data collected from the selected female-headed households through a structured questionnaire. Various statistical tools such as graphic analysis, percentage analysis, median, and standard deviation are used to analyse the data and present the findings.

The fifth and final chapter presents the major findings, suggestions, and conclusion of the study. This chapter also includes the bibliography and the questionnaire used for the study.

CHAPTER II

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

2.1 Review of Literature

A review of literature is a critical analysis and synthesis of existing research and scholarly works on a specific topic. It serves as a foundational component of academic research, providing context, identifying gaps, and establishing the significance of the study. The process involves systematically searching for, evaluating, and summarizing published materials such as journal articles, books, conference papers, and theses. A well-conducted literature review not only highlights key themes, theories, and methodologies within the field but also demonstrates the researcher's understanding of the subject's historical and current landscape. It helps to situate the research within the broader academic discourse, showing how the proposed study builds on or diverges from previous work. Additionally, a literature review can reveal inconsistencies, contradictions, or areas requiring further exploration, thereby guiding the formulation of research questions or hypotheses. Effective literature reviews are characterized by their organization, critical engagement with sources, and ability to draw meaningful connections between studies. They are essential for ensuring that research is original, relevant, and contributes meaningfully to the body of knowledge in a given field.

- **Asian Development Bank; World Bank.** (2018), The study highlights that migration and remittances play a major role in Asia and the Pacific by providing foreign exchange and improving household spending on education and health, while also noting the social risks faced by migrant workers, and emphasizes the need to enhance migrant welfare and promote productive use of remittances for economic development.
- **Askarov & Doucouliagos.** (2020), in a World Development meta-analysis of 1,343 estimates from 73 studies across 30 countries, found that remittances significantly increase household education expenditure by about 15%–35% (up to 53% in Latin America), effectively acting as a key driver for investing in children’s education and reducing dropout rates. Remittances for economic development.
- **David doyle.** (2015),the study examines remittances are a significant source of foreign exchange for developing economies. Remittances, due to their compensation and insurance functions, will increase the general income level and economic security

of recipients, thereby reducing their perceived income risk. Over time, this will dampen demand from recipients for government taxation and social insurance. Therefore, increases in income remitted to an economy to result in reduced levels of social welfare transfers at the macro-level.

- **Dilip** .(2005), analysed workers ' remittances have become an increasingly prominent source of external funding for many developing countries. This chapter examines the relative importance of workers' remittances as a source of development finance and discusses measures that industrial and developing countries could take to increase remittances.
- **Dr. Sunita Kumari & Chandra Shekar Dwivedi** .(2021), emphasized that Women's empowerment is gauged by remittance sending, a traditionally male domain in India's patriarchal society. The NSS 64th round shows many women also remit, reshaping gender relations. Wealthier (first-quartile) women and men remit more; economically backward states (except South India) have higher remittances.
- **Eric & Abokyi** .(2023), analysed data from 102 developing countries (2011–2017) and found that remittances significantly reduce the gender gap in financial inclusion. As major recipients, women leverage these inflows to access formal financial services, strengthening economic participation and narrowing gender-based disparities
- **Hennbery J & J. Holliday et** al.(2017), Conducted a study on how traditional labour migration focuses on economic benefits, overlooking gender differences. It argues that existing models ignore women's contributions and costs, and aims to highlight the rights needed for inclusive development. The report seeks a gender-sensitive approach to enhance opportunities for women migrant workers.
- **Hyderali.K& Amina Poovancheri at al**.(2025) ,their study analyses in Kerala, major chunk of state income obtained through migration and remittance. Remittance received by the state has manyfold socio-economic consequences. This paper verifies trends and patterns of remittance in Kerala by using Kerala Migration Survey (KMS) as prime data source.
- **International Organisation for Migration.** (2010), study explains that remittances are a vital source of income for many households and that gender plays an important role in how money is sent and used. It highlights that women and men migrants differ in remittance patterns and spending priorities, and stresses the need for gender-

sensitive policies and better sex-disaggregated data to improve the development impact of remittances.

- **Islam & Tamanna ,et al.** (2018) Conducted a study on Role of Women in Remittance-Earning Households: Evidence from Sylhet City, Bangladesh. The study examines the role of women in remittance-earning households in Sylhet city, Bangladesh. It finds that women play a crucial role in managing household finances, with 95% handling banking, 80% paying bills, and taking care of children and household chores. Many households (42 out of 60) rely on foreign remittances as their primary income source, and women often take on this responsibility in the absence of male family members. The study highlights the importance of understanding women's roles in these households for policy-making and future initiatives.
- **James & Hutter et al.** (2015) ,conducted a study using the nationally representative data drawn from NSSO 64th round, the paper investigates the impact of remittances both internal and international on the expenditure patterns of households in India, with special focus on Uttar Pradesh and Kerala and Karnataka.
- **Kannan .K.P & Hari K.S**.(2002) ,They attempt to construct a time series estimation of remittances from abroad to the Kerala economy for the period 1972 to 2000. It is now widely acknowledged that foreign remittances in the economy of the State of Kerala in India in the form of money sent by its workers in the Gulf countries play a crucial role. The study finds that by the early nineties remittances to the Kerala economy assumed a significant share of state income
- **Kollmair &Michael et al.** (2006) ,the study examines labour migration and remittances are major economic mainstays for Nepal's economy. However, there is still insufficient documentation on scale and significance of this process. Estimations of migration figures suggest that real numbers are several times higher than official statistics show.
- **Kristin Gobal.** (2013), study estimates the impact of migrants' remittances on households' spending decisions in Ecuador. Applying both parametric and semiparametric techniques, found strong evidence that remittances enhance expenditures on education, health, and housing, but decrease expenditures on food.
- **Meher Seemarani & Lopamudra Mishra**. (2025),The study analyses the impact of remittances on economic growth in India from 1980 to 2021, using annual time series data sourced from World Development Indicators, World Bank. This study utilizes the

Johansen co-integration test, Vector Error Correction Model (VECM) and Granger Causality test to investigate the long-term equilibrium linkages and short-run dynamics among gross domestic product, gross capital formation and remittances. The findings indicate the existence of long-run relationship, suggesting that capital stock has a positive and significant impact on growth, whereas remittances contribute positively to economic performance, their impact is relatively modest, because a substantial portion of remitted funds is directed toward household consumption and non-productive use rather than investment in productive sectors.

- **Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation.** (2016). Studied labour moves from subsistence to developed sectors. Remittances support households, reduce poverty, and aid income diversification. They're a stable finance source, funding daily needs and sometimes luxury goods. More study needed.
- **Oberi S & Manmohan Singh .H K**. (1990),emphasized that Rural–urban migration research ignores rural impacts. Migrants' remittances may raise rural income & spur tech change, or be spent on housing/education or wasted on luxury, possibly harming work habits. The net effect of remittances on rural economy is ambiguous: they can boost investment or fuel unproductive consumption.
- **PubMed Study** .(2021),Patterned remittances enhance women's health-related autonomy — finds regular remittances improve women's healthcare decision-making and autonomy.
- **Rahman, M. M.& Fee, L. K**. (2009),Their study explores and suggests a methodological approach to the gender dimensions of remittances. It argues that remittances should be seen as a social process and examined in relation to (i) the sending side, (ii) the recipient side and (iii) gendered use of remittances by the households. Focusing on Indonesian domestic workers in Singapore, Malaysia and Hong Kong, and migrant households in Central Java, it explores the gender dimensions of remittance-sending, receiving, control and use, and their development implications.
- **Rahman& Mizanur .M D.** (2015), study analyses remittance plays a significant role in accelerating macro-economic growth and is unarguably a vital source of finance at micro level in developing countries. Remittance inflows enhance the foreign exchange, foreign reserve and meet up trade balance. It has great potential to and an

endeavour of unveiling the prospects of socio-economic development of left-behind families and communities in rural Bangladesh .

- **Raihan, S., & Uddin M et al.** (2022), Their study analyses the impact of international remittances on household spending behaviour in the Bangladesh context. The total household spending has been classified into seven categories, namely education, health, food, consumed and durable goods, housing and land, investment and other consumption.
- **Ruksana . M.M.& Dr.Gangatharan K** .(2016),their study analyses international migration has an important role in the economic development of every economy. In Kerala, most of the people prefer to emigrate for skilled and unskilled labour to the developed countries to improve the living standards of their families.
- **Roy et al.** (2024), studied that remittances significantly boost agricultural productivity and investment, especially within female-headed households in rural India. These funds are often directed towards improving agricultural infrastructure and inputs, with women playing a key decision-making role in their utilization.
- **Sarina Jain .** (2015), The study explains that remittances can strengthen women's economic role by increasing their control over household finances, with women often using remitted income for essential needs like education, health, and family welfare, though social and institutional barriers may limit this empowerment.
- **Science Direct** .(2022),study on Nepali households reveals that remittances significantly boost spending on education, healthcare, and food, while reducing, not increasing, consumption of "temptation goods" like alcohol and tobacco.
- **Sharon H Green et al**. (2019), analyses the consequences for women left behind by virtue of temporary male migration are mixed. On the one hand, concomitant changes in fertility, participation in the labour force, and social norms are often associated with increased independence for women. On the other hand, women left behind can be vulnerable to increased dependency on members of their husbands' family or face limited access to social institutions. These shifts in women's capacity for decision making can have important implications for their health and well-being.
- **Surendra Basnet**.(2024),The study discusses international migration, noting 184 million people live abroad, with many from low- and middle-income countries like Nepal, where half of families rely on remittances. Research on Remittance Receiving

Households (RRHs) examines expenditure patterns and socio-demographic traits, using diary-based income and spending records.

- **Tumbe & Chinmay** .(2015),examined domestic and international remittances in India. Key points include a $10 domestic remittance market (2007-08), with 60% being inter-State transfers and 80% going to rural areas. These remittances fund over 30% of consumption for 10% of rural households, with high dependency in Bihar, UP, and Rajasthan. Notably, 70% of remittances are informal, presenting a huge opportunity for financial institutions. Internationally, Kerala, Punjab, and Goa are top remittance recipients.
- **UNCDF**.(2020-2021), The report studies digital remittances, focusing on women, and finds barriers like low digital literacy and high costs widen financial health gaps. It suggests women-centred design, financial education, and gender-responsive policies to help. COVID-19 highlighted a digital divide affecting vulnerable groups, especially women.
- **World Bank Group** .(2021),study emphasis the gender roles in sending, receiving and utilizing remittances is oftentimes overlooked given the general focus on the household. However, the World Bank experience with Project Greenback[1] in the Western Balkans[2] revealed some clear differences between men and women in terms of behaviours and attitudes related to remittances. Accounting for these differences is important for public authorities and remittances industry in their efforts to maximize the development impact of remittances in the region as a vital source of income and a gateway to broader financial inclusion.

CHAPTER III

PROFILE OF THE STUDY AREA

PROFILE OF THE STUDY

3.1 Profile of the study

The study titled "Women as Financial Architects: The Role of Female-Headed Households in Optimizing Foreign Remittance Utilisation – A Study of Sulthan Bathery Thaluk" focuses on examining how women who head households in Sulthan Bathery Thaluk of Wayanad district, Kerala, manage and utilise foreign remittances received from migrant family members. Sulthan Bathery, a region characterized by significant overseas migration, particularly to Gulf countries, has a considerable number of families dependent on remittance income for their livelihood. In the absence of male members due to migration, women assume primary responsibility for financial decision-making, including allocation of funds for consumption, savings, education, healthcare, debt repayment, asset creation, and small-scale investments. This study analyses the socio-economic profile of these female-headed households, patterns of remittance inflow, decision-making authority, and the overall impact of remittance utilisation on household welfare and economic stability. By highlighting women's role as active financial planners rather than passive recipients of income, the study aims to contribute to a better understanding of gendered financial management, economic empowerment, and local development within the specific context of Sulthan Bathery Thaluk.

Map 3.1 Profile of the Study



CHAPTER IV

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

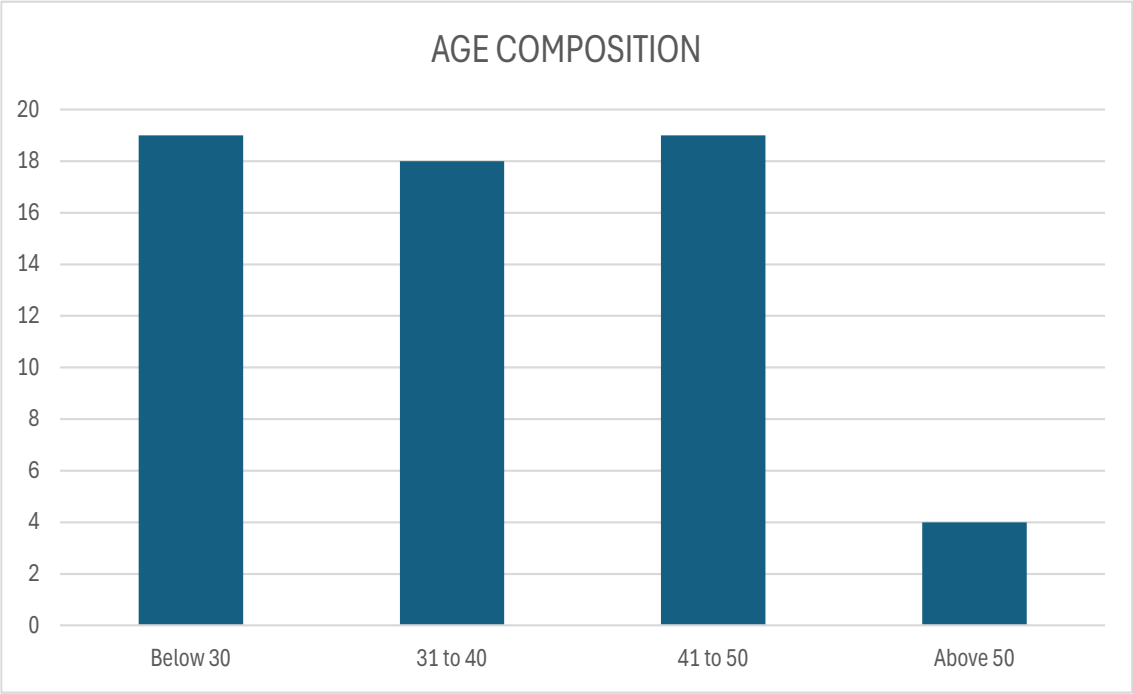
Table 4.1

Age composition of respondents

Categories	No. of respondents
Below 30	19
31 to 40	18
41 to 50	19
Above 50	4
Total	**60**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.1



INTERPRETATION: Out of the 60 samples 19 respondents belong to below 30 and 41 to 50 age group ,18 people belong to 31 to 40 and 4 respondents belong to above 50 age-category.

Table 4.2

Annual amount of remittance

Annual amount of remittance	Frequency	Cumulative frequency
Below 1 Lakh	18	18
1 Lakh to 3Lakh	20	38
3 Lakh to 5 Lakh	12	50
Above 5 Lakh	10	60
Total	**60**	

Source: primary data

Median = 1 + [(30 - 18) / 20] × 2

2.2 lakh

Median Annual Amount of Remittance = ₹2.2 lakh

INTERPRETATION: The median annual amount of remittance is ₹2.2 lakh, indicating that 50% of respondents receive remittances below ₹2.2 lakh and the remaining 50% receive above ₹2.2 lakh.

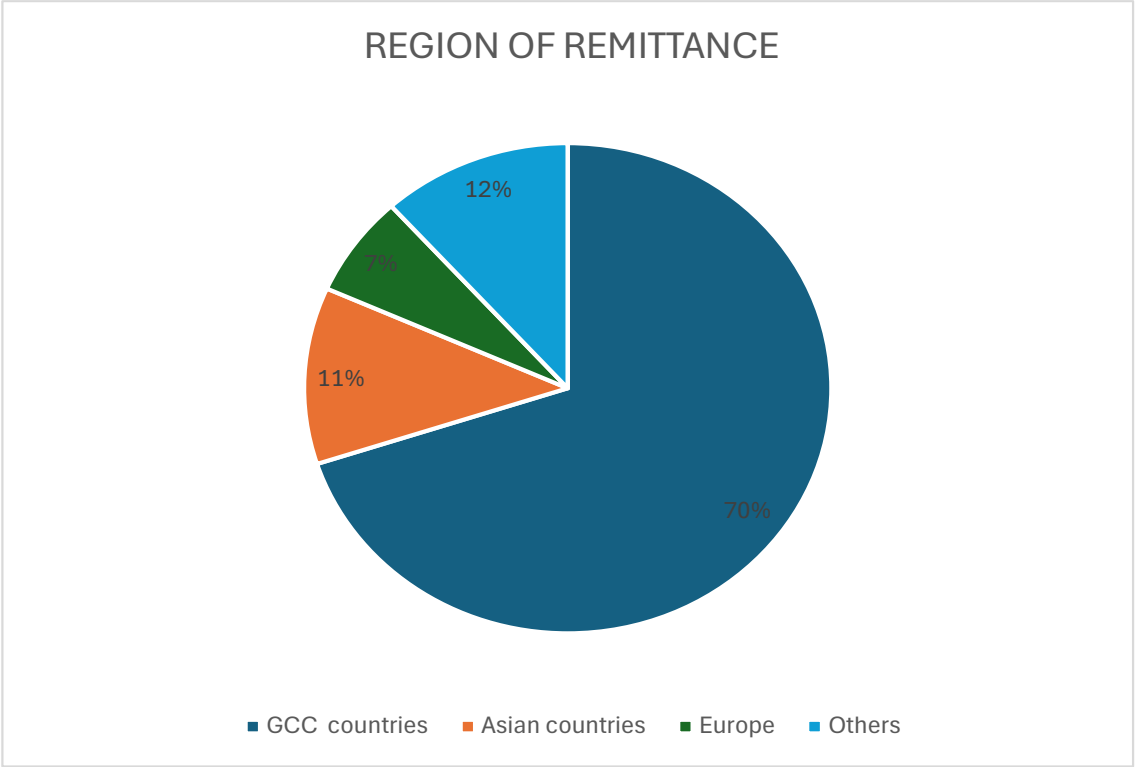
Table 4.3

Region of remittance

Region of remittance	No. of respondents	Percentage
GCC countries	42	70%
Asian countries	7	11%
Europe	4	7%
Others	7	12%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.2



INTERPRETATION: 70% respondents receive remittance from GCC countries, 11.6% from Asian countries, 6.6% from Europe and 11.6 % from others.

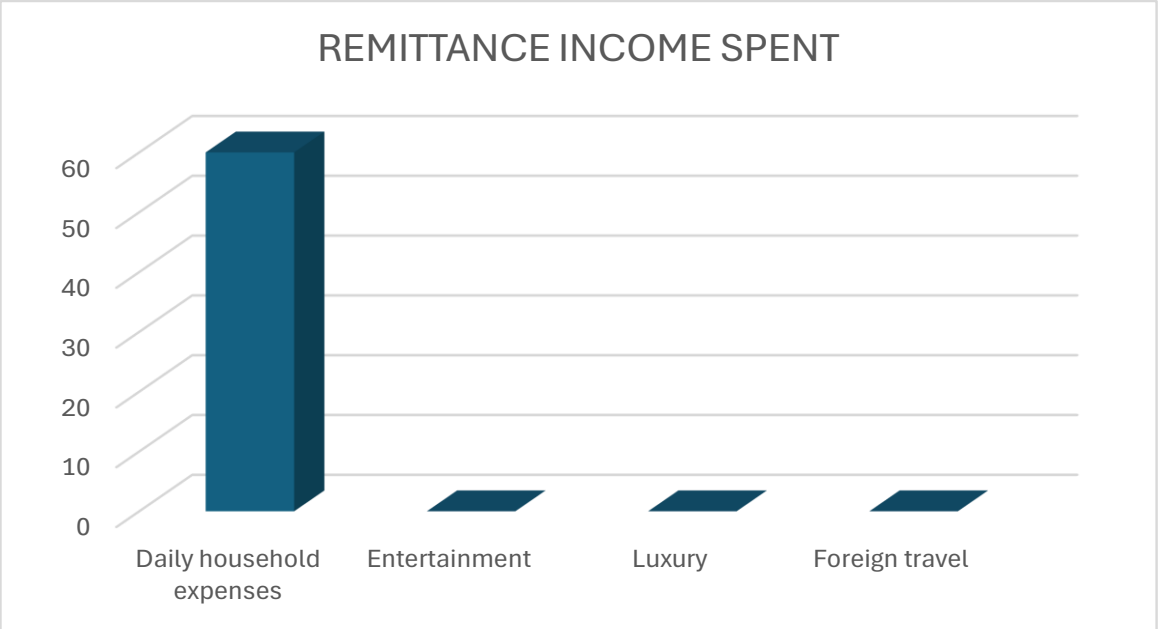
Table 4.4

Remittance income spent

Heads	No. of respondents
Daily household expenses	60
Entertainment	0
Luxury	0
Foreign travel	0
Total	**60**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.3



INTERPRETATION: All respondents use remittance money for household expenses none of the respondents spent remittance income for entertainment, luxury and foreign travel.

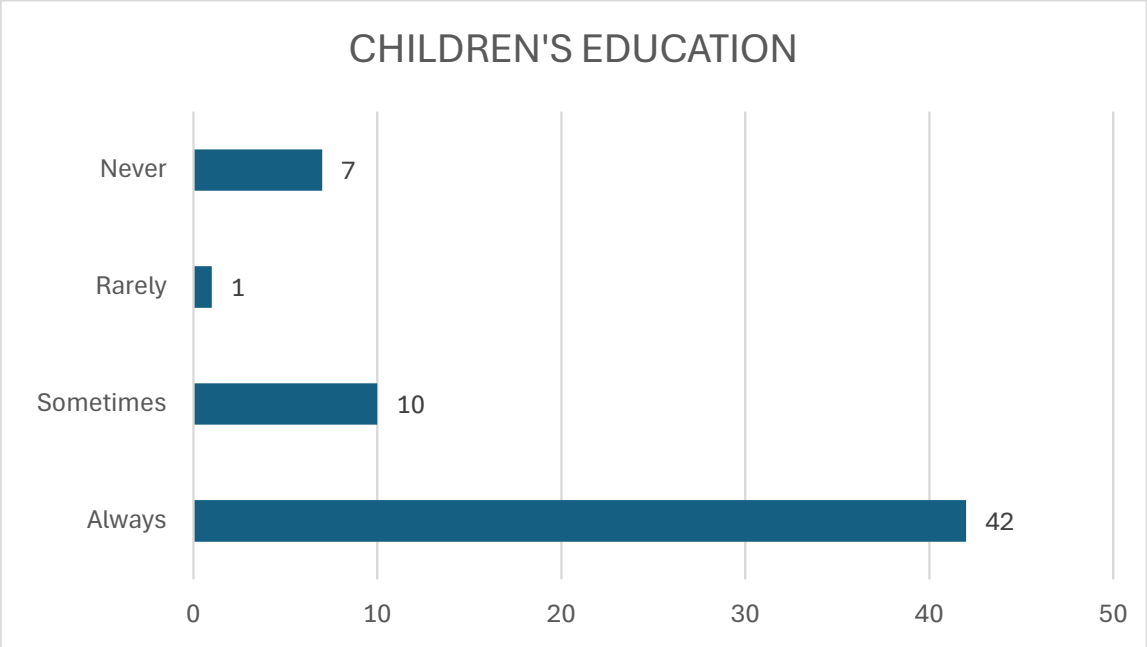
Table 4.5

Remittance for children's education

Categories	No. of respondents
Always	42
Sometimes	10
Rarely	1
Never	7
Total	**60**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.4



INTERPRETATION: 42 of respondents always use remittance money for children's education,10 respondents uses sometimes ,7 never use and 1 rarely use remittance money.

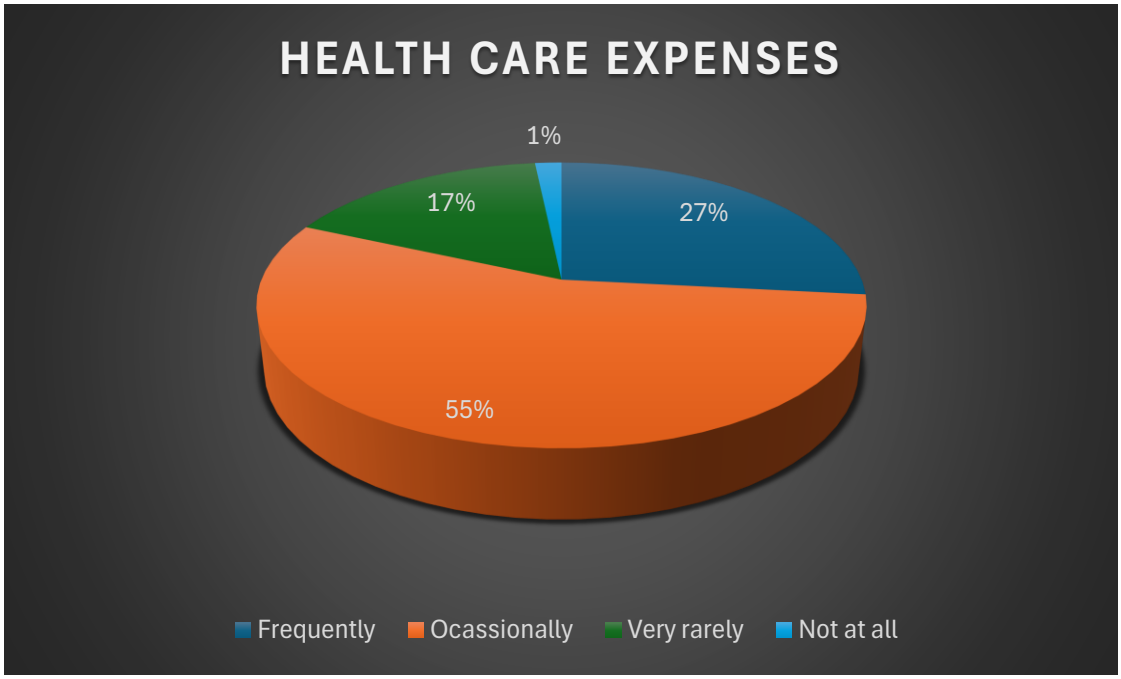
Table 4.6

Remittance money for healthcare expenses

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Frequently	16	27%
Occasionally	33	55%
Very rarely	10	17%
Not at all	1	1%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.5



INTERPRETATION: 55%of respondents occasionally use remittance money for healthcare expenses, 27% respondents use frequently,17% use very rarely and 1% not at all.

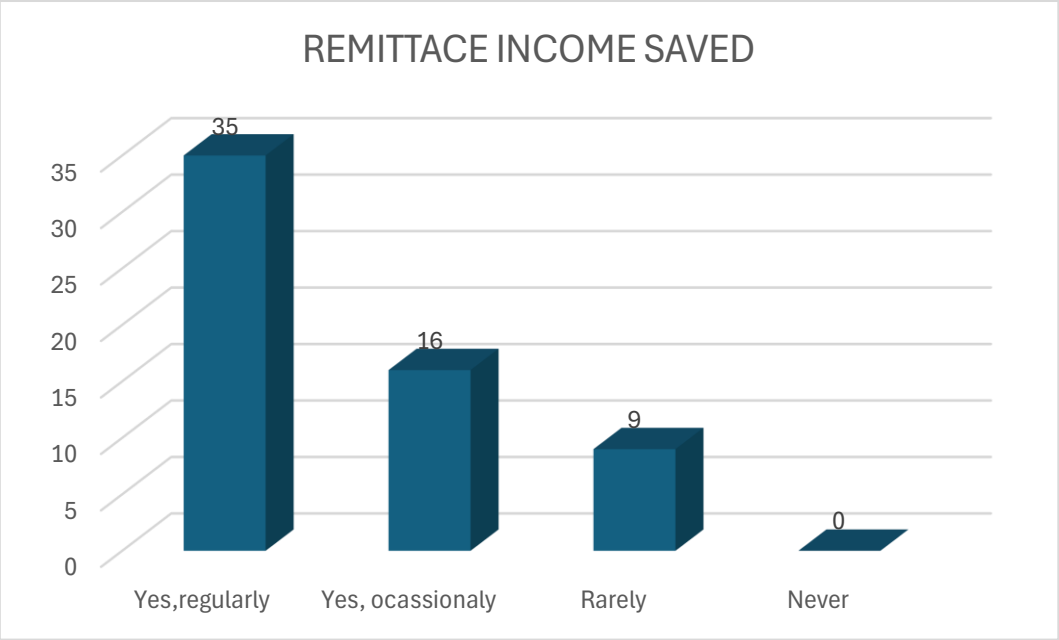
Table 4.7

Remittance income saved

Heads	No. of respondents
Yes, regularly	35
Yes, occasionally	16
Rarely	9
Never	0
Total	**60**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.6



INTERPRETATION: 35 number of respondents regularly save remittance income ,16 occasionally save, 9 are rarely, 0 never save.

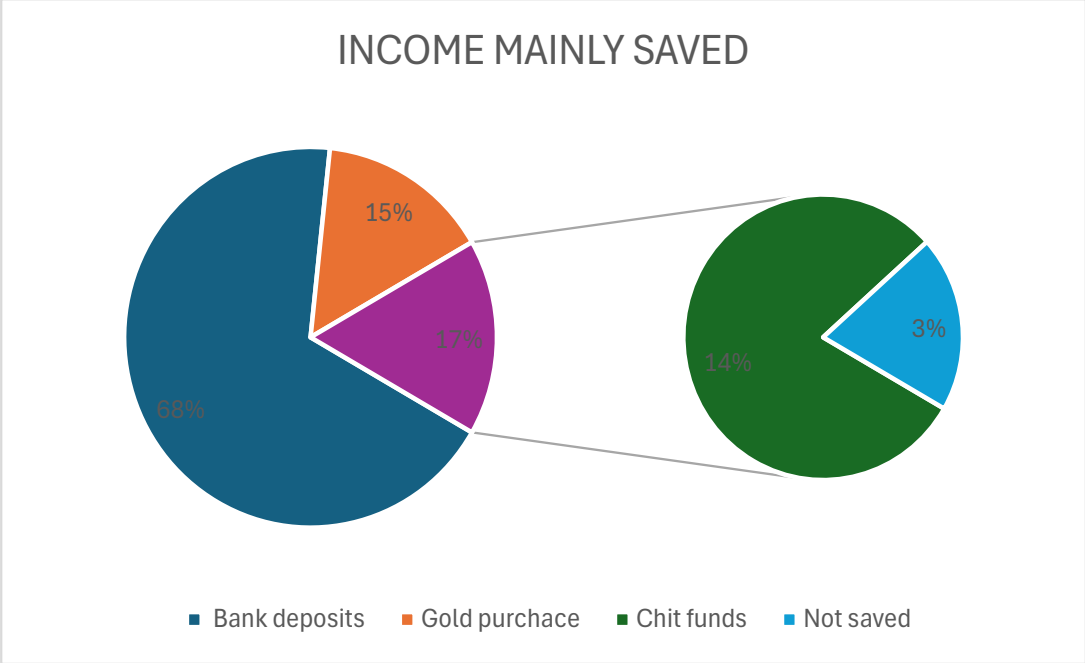
Table 4.8

Income mainly saved

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Bank deposits	41	68%
Gold purchase	9	15%
Chit funds	8	14%
Not saved	2	3%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.7



INTERPRETATION: 68% of respondents mainly save remittance money on bank deposits,15% in gold purchase,14% on chit funds and 3% are not saved.

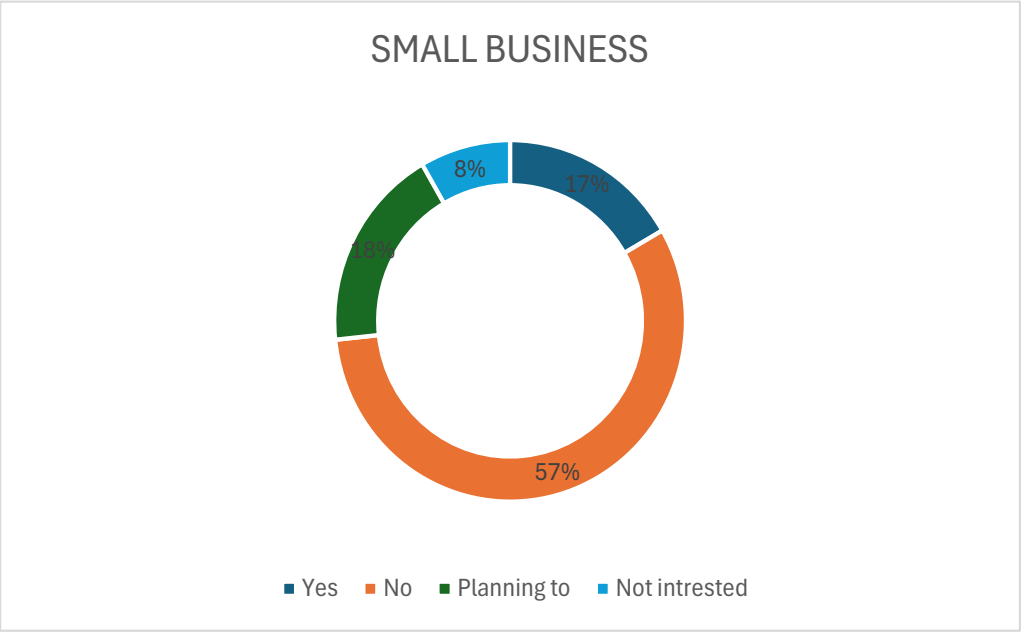
Table 4.9

Remittance income in small business

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Yes	10	12%
No	34	57%
Planning to	11	18%
Not interested	5	8%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.8



INTERPRETATION: 57% of respondents are not part of any small businesses ,18% are planning to,12% are involved and 8% are not interested in any businesses.

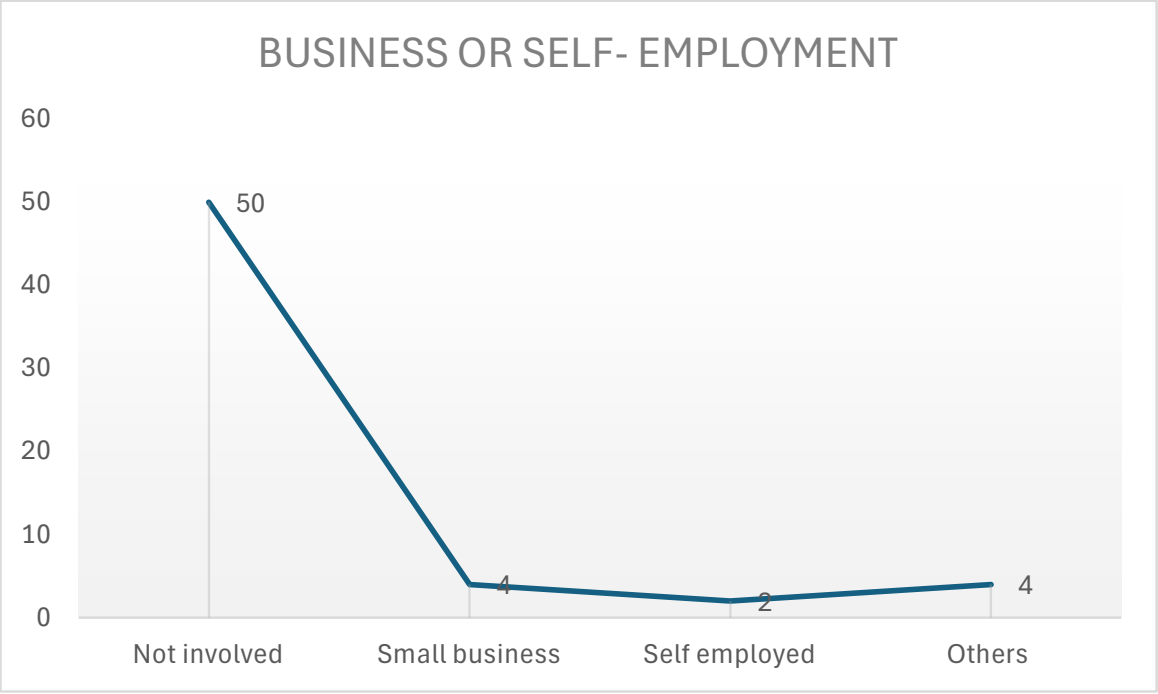
Table 4.10

Business or self-employment

Classes	No. of respondents
Not involved	50
Small business	4
Self employed	2
Others	4
Total	**60**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.9



INTERPRETATION: 50 respondents are not involved in any business,4 respondents are part of small business and others and 2 respondents are self-employed.

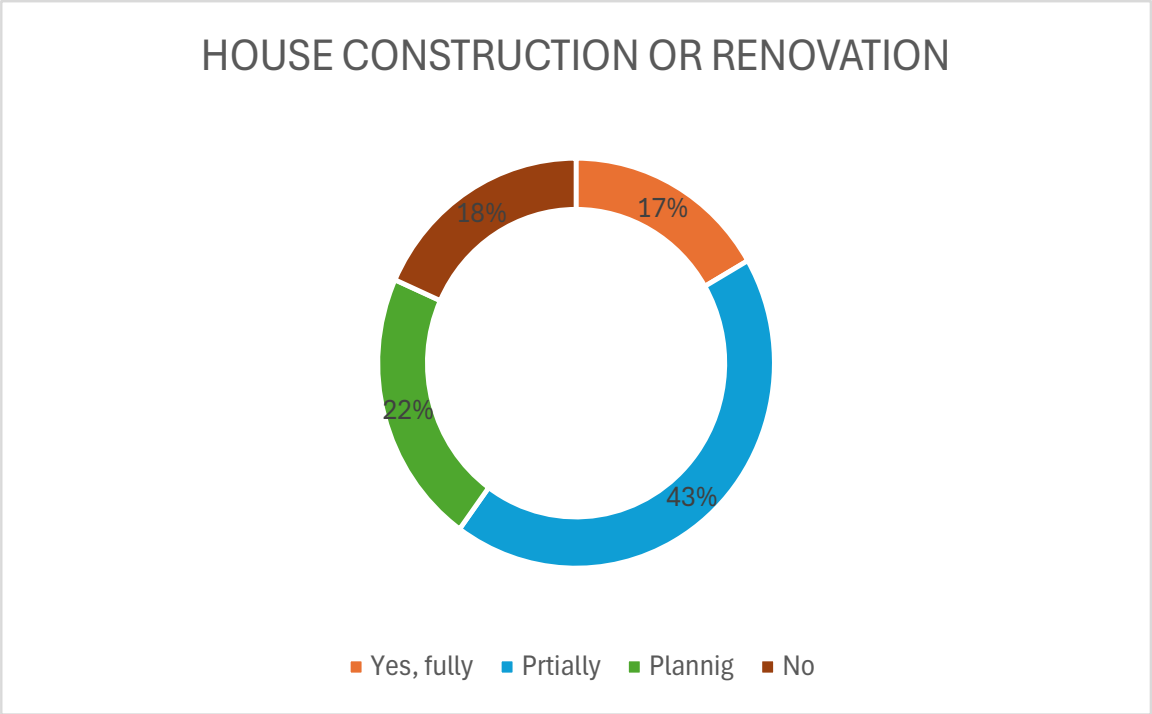
Table 4.11

Remittance for house construction or renovation

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Yes, fully	10	17%
Partially	26	43%
Planning	13	22%
No	11	18%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.10



INTERPRETATION:43% of respondents are partially used remittance income for house construction or renovation,22% are planning,18% are not used and 17% are fully used.

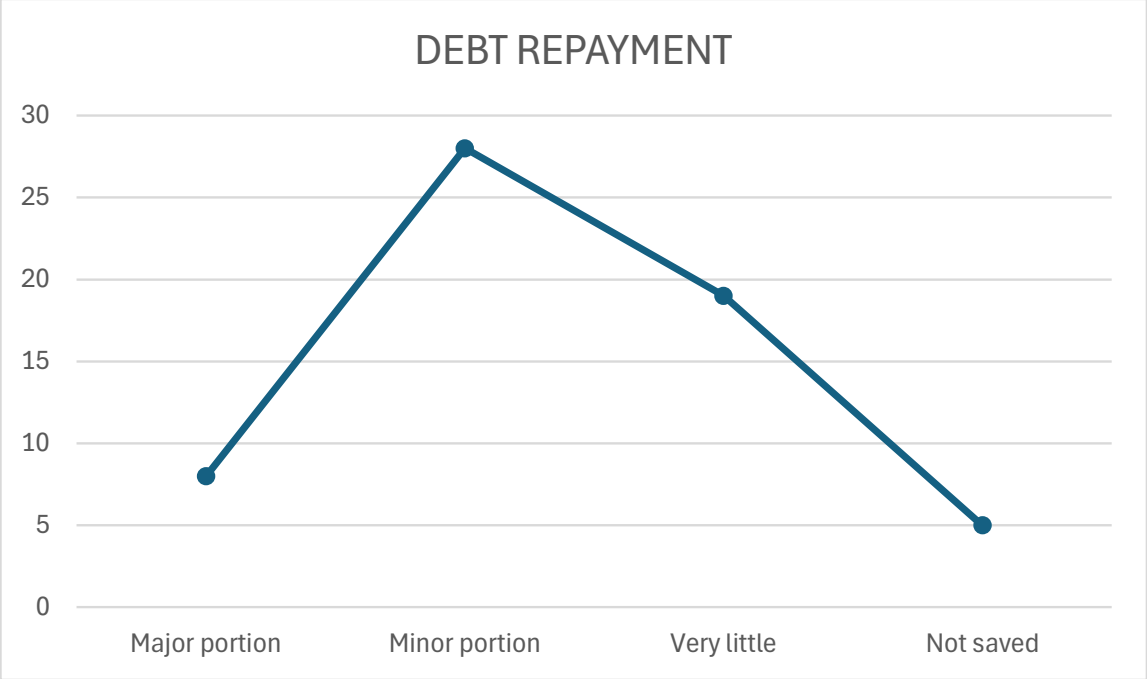
Table 4.12

Debt repayment

Heads	No. of respondents
Major portion	8
Minor portion	28
Very little	19
Not saved	5
Total	**60**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.11



INTERPRETATION:28 respondents are used minor portion of remittance for debt repayment, 19 are used very little portion, 8 are used major portion and 5 are not saved for repayment of debt.

Table 4.13

Improvement in household consumption

Categories	Frequency	Score
Significantly	30	4
Moderately	21	3
Slightly	7	2
Not at all	2	1
Total	**60**	

Source: primary data

Mean ($\bar{x}$) = $\Sigma fx / N$

=3.32

Table 4.13.1

Standard Deviation Calculation

x	f	x- $\bar{x}$	(x- $\bar{x}$)²	f(x − $\bar{x}$)²
4	30	0.68	0.4624	13.872
3	21	-0.32	0.1024	2.1504
2	7	-1.32	1.7424	12.1968
1	2	-2.32	5.3824	10.7648

$\Sigma f(x - \bar{x})^2 = 38.984$

N = 60

SD = $\sqrt{[\Sigma f(x - \bar{x})^2 / N}$

=0.81

INTERPRETION: The mean score of 3.32 indicates that respondents generally experienced a moderate to significant improvement in household consumption due to remittance income. The standard deviation of 0.81 shows that responses are closely clustered around the mean, indicating relatively low variation in respondents' opinions regarding the impact of remittance on household consumption.

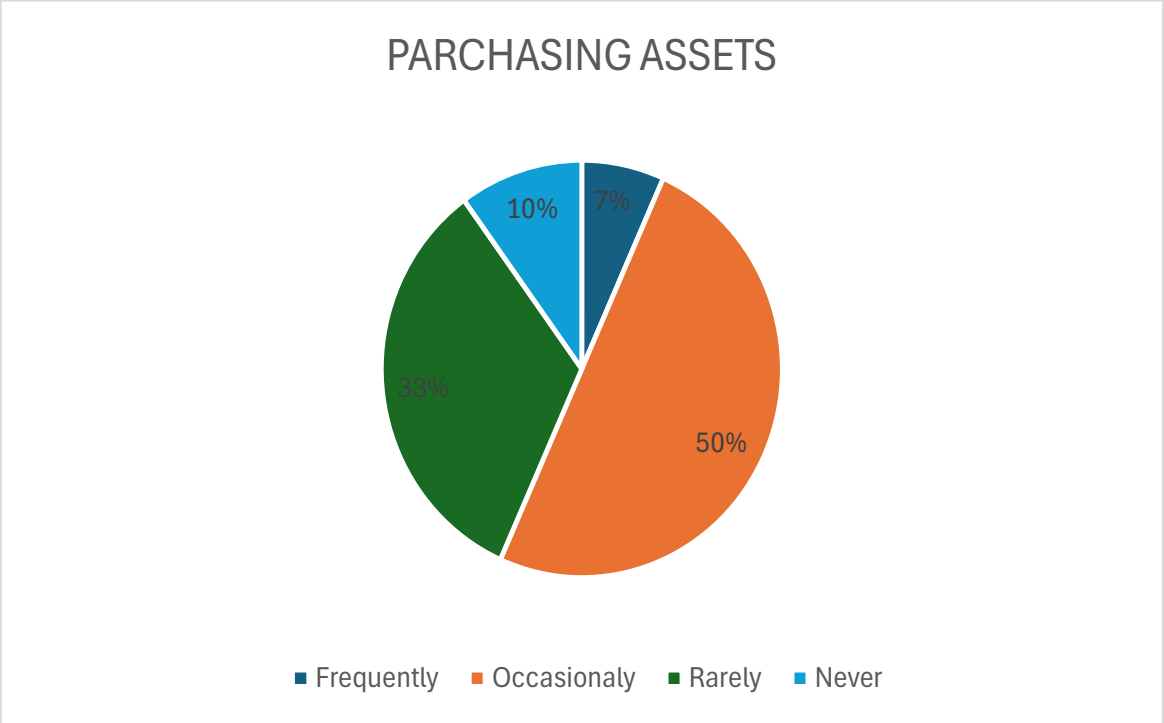
Table 4.14

Purchasing assets

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Frequently	4	7%
Occasionally	30	50%
Rarely	20	33%
Never	6	10%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.12



INTERPRETATION: 50% of respondents purchase assets occasionally ,33% rarely purchase,10% never purchase and 7% frequently.

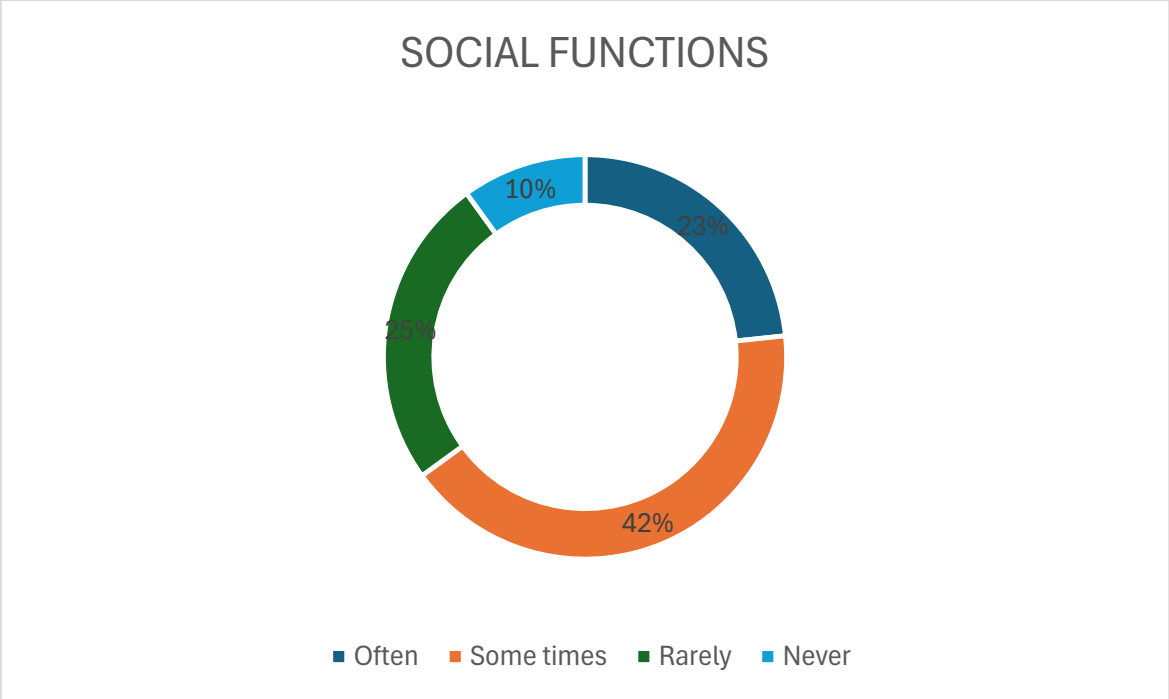
Table 4.15

Remittance for social functions

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Often	14	23%
Some times	25	42%
Rarely	15	25%
Never	6	10%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.13



INTERPRETATION: 42% of respondents sometimes use remittance for social functions, 23% often uses ,25% rarely uses and 10% never use.

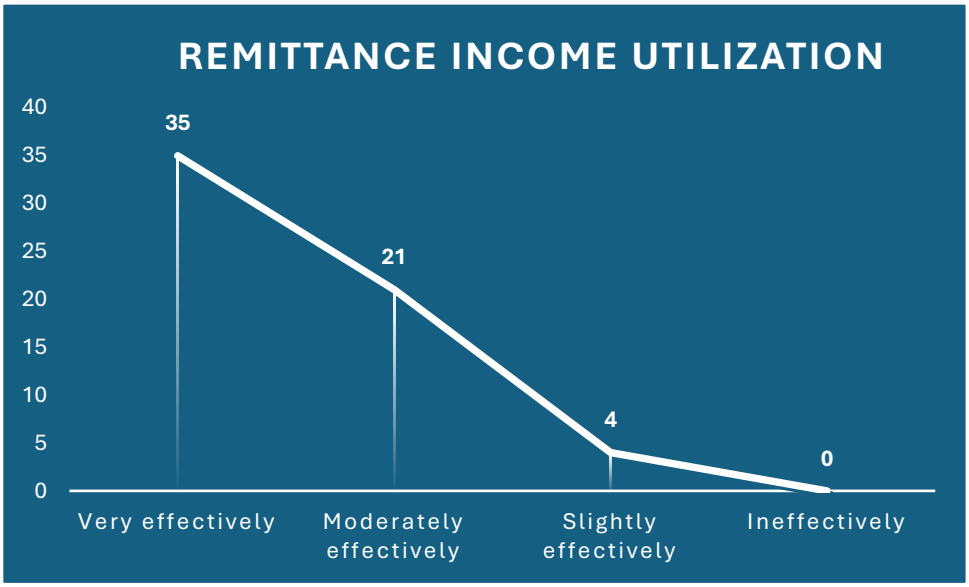
Table 4.16

Remittance income utilization

Categories	No. of respondents
Very effectively	35
Moderately effectively	21
Slightly effectively	4
Ineffectively	0
Total	**60**

Source : Primary Data

Figure 4.14



INTERPRETATION:38 respondents utilized remittance very effectively, 21respondents utilized moderately effectively,4 respondents slightly effectively and o respondents ineffectively.

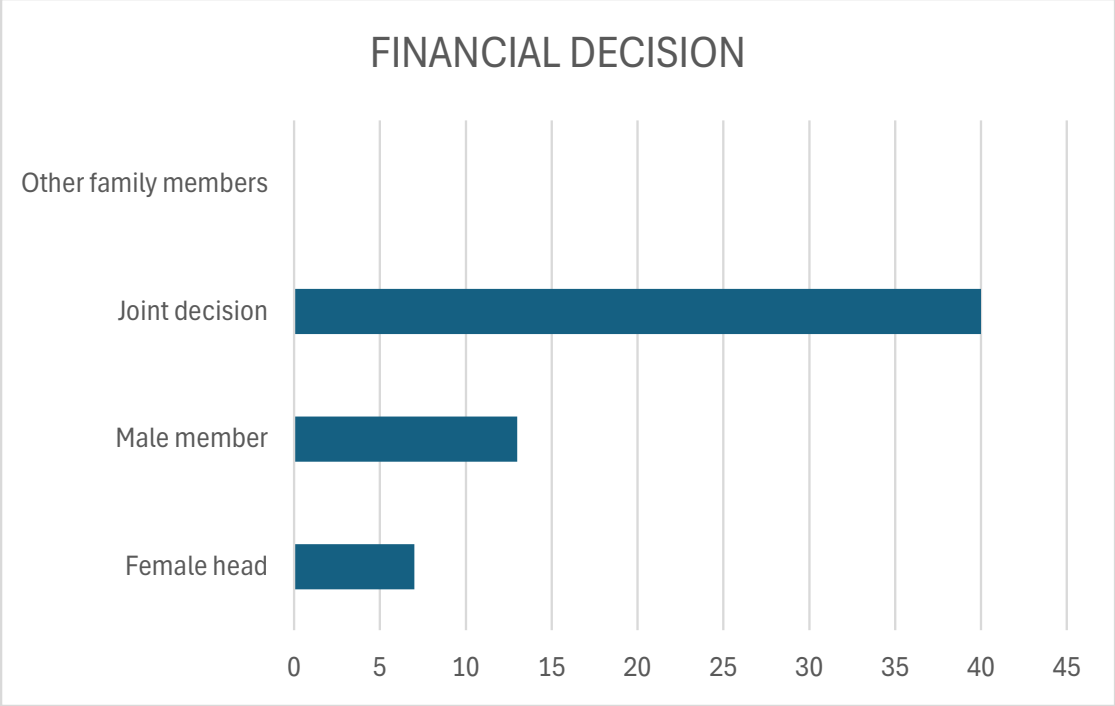
Table 4.17

Financial decision in household

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Female head	7	12%
Male member	13	22%
Joint decision	40	67%
Other family members	0	0%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source :primary data

Figure 4.15



INTERPRETATION:67% respondents make joint decision in household,22% by male member,12% by female head and 0% by other family members.

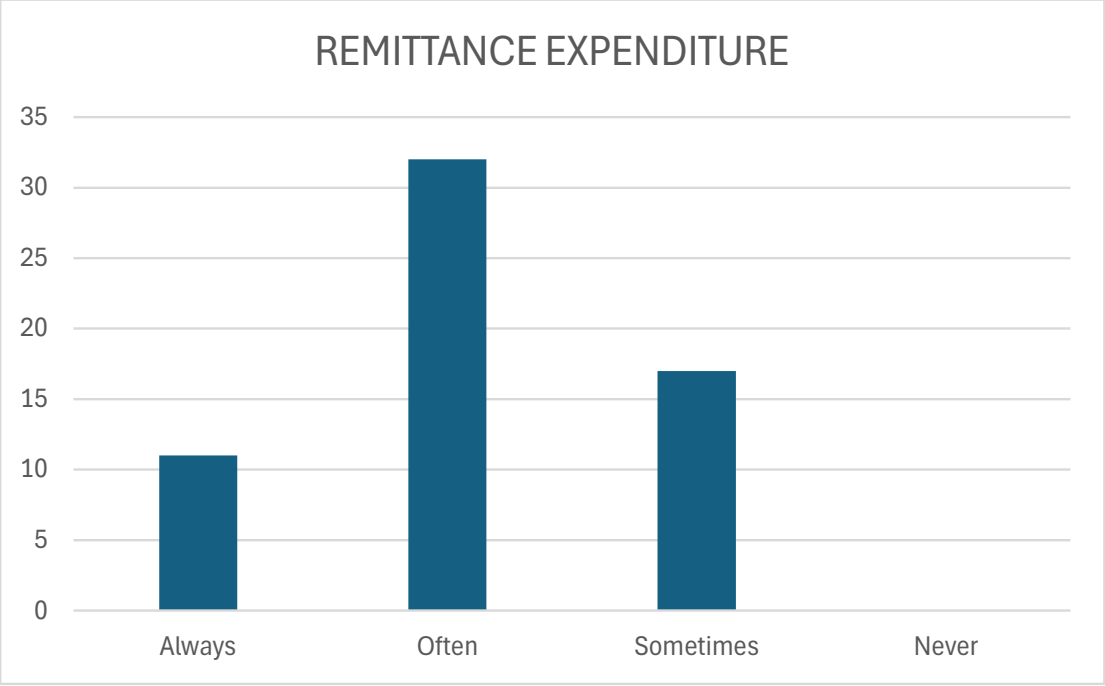
Table 4.18

Remittance expenditure by female head

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Always	11	18.3%
Often	32	53.3%
Sometimes	17	28.3%
Never	0	0%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source:primary data

Figure 4.16



INTERPRETATION:53.3% of respondents say female heads often decide hoe remittance is spent, 28.3% report sometimes , 18.3% report women always have full control and 0% reported never ,showing women no exclusion of women.

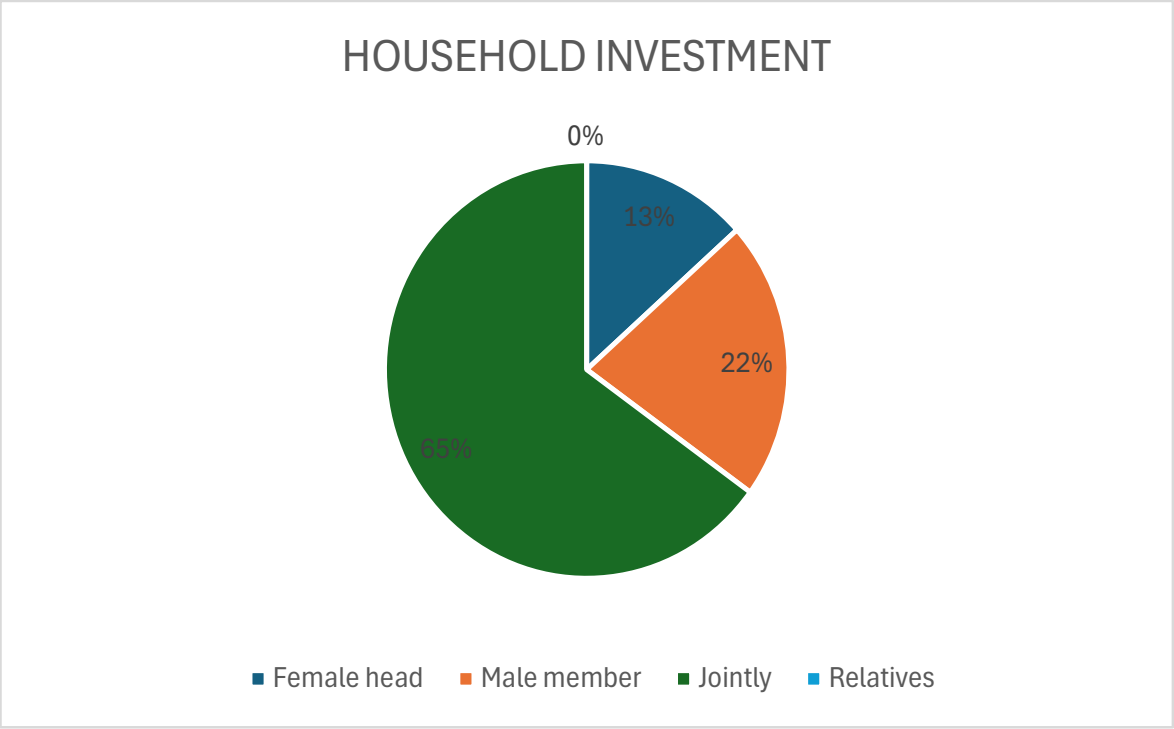
Table 4.19

Decision about house hold investment

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Female head	8	13.3%
Male member	13	22%
Jointly	39	65%
Relatives	0	0%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source:primary data

Figure 4.17



INTERPRETATION: 65% respondents reported major decisions are made jointly,22% are by male member ,13.3% by female head and 0% by relatives.

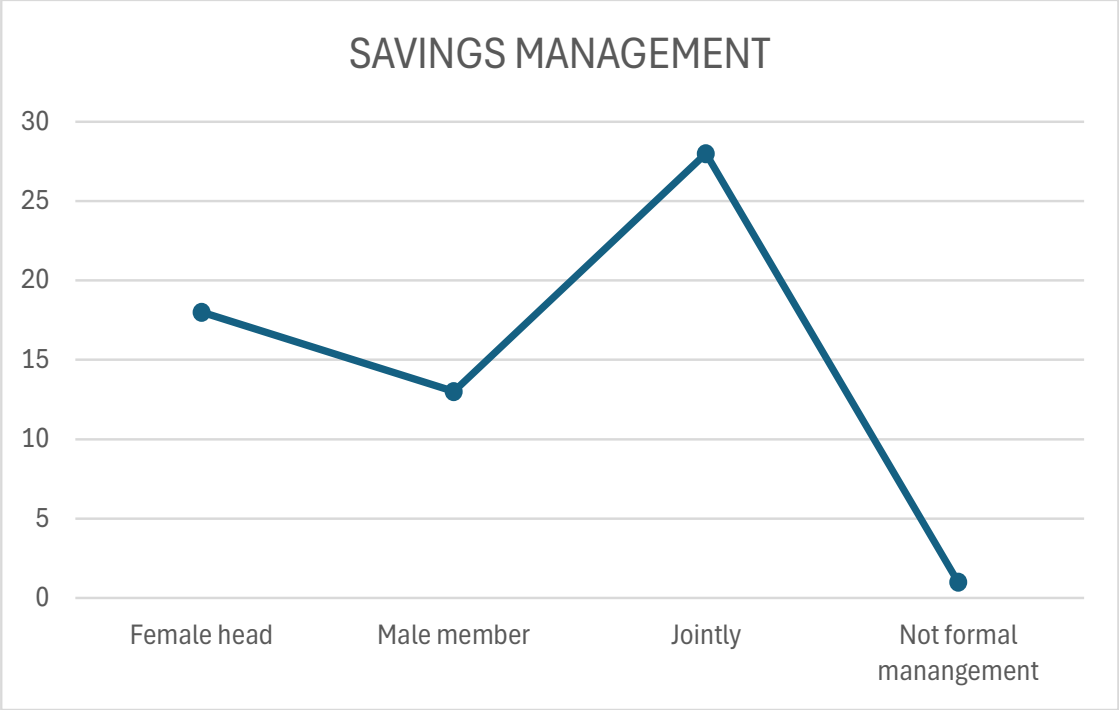
Table 4.20

Household savings management

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Female head	18	30%
Male member	13	22%
Jointly	28	47%
Not formal management	1	2%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.18



INTERPRETATION: 47% of household manage savings jointly, 30% handle by female head,22% by male member and 2% of household have no formal management.

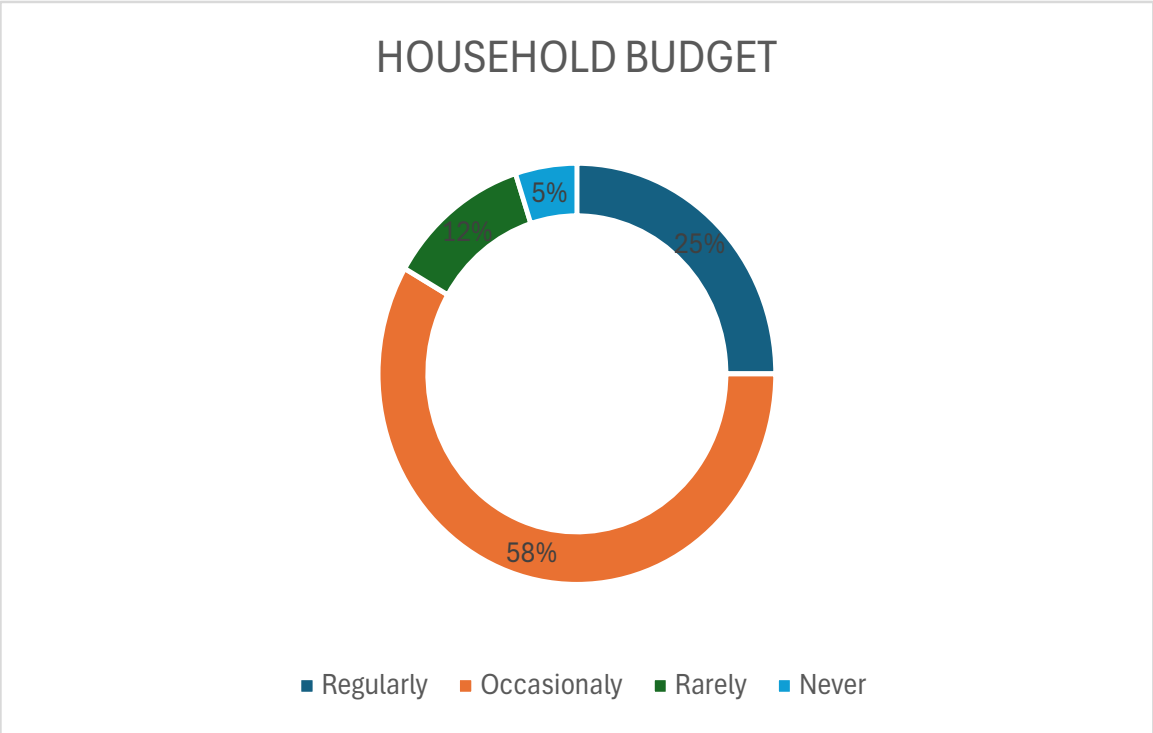
Table 4.21

Female head preparing household budget

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Regularly	15	25%
Occasionally	35	58%
Rarely	7	12%
Never	3	5%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.19



INTERPRETATION: 58% of household female occasionally prepare budget, 25% by regularly,12% are Rarely and 5% never prepare budget.

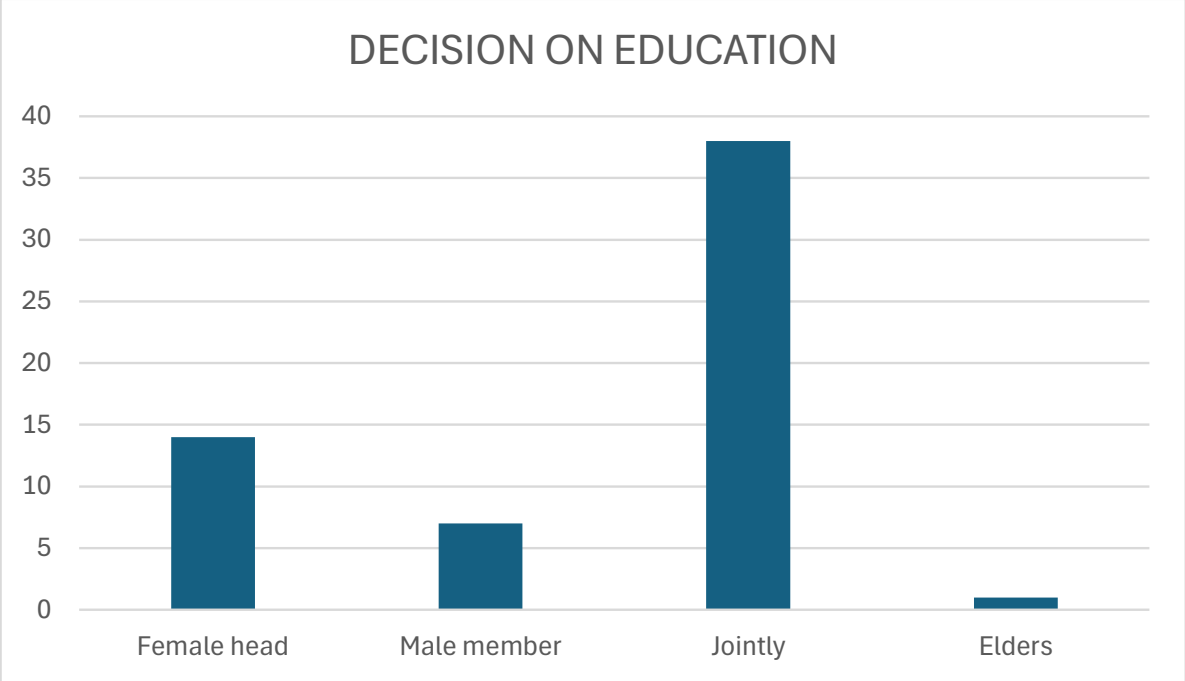
Table 4.22

Decision about children's education

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Female head	14	23.3%
Male member	7	12%
Jointly	38	63.3%
Elders	1	2%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.20



INTEPRETATION:63.3% of respondents jointly make decisions about children's education,23.3% by female head,12% by male member and 2% by elders.

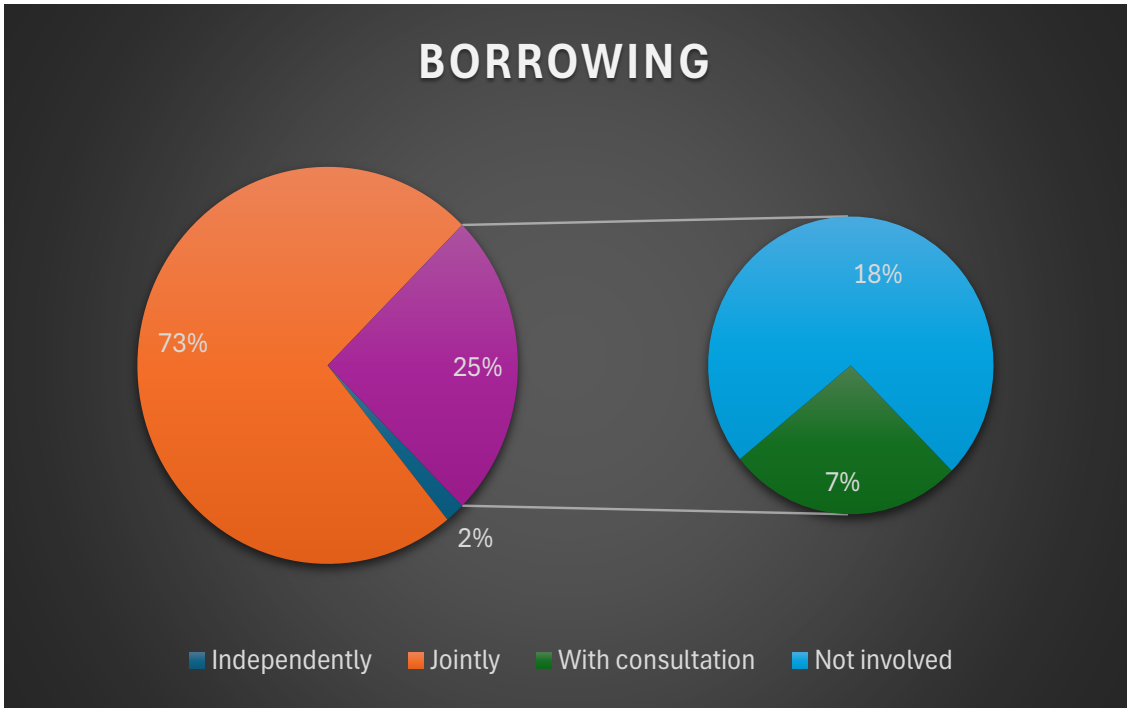
Table 4.23

Decision regarding borrowing

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Independently	1	2%
Jointly	44	73%
With consultation	4	7%
Not involved	11	18%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.21



INTERPRETATION:73% of respondents make joint decision,18% not involved in borrowing,75 with consultation and 2% independently.

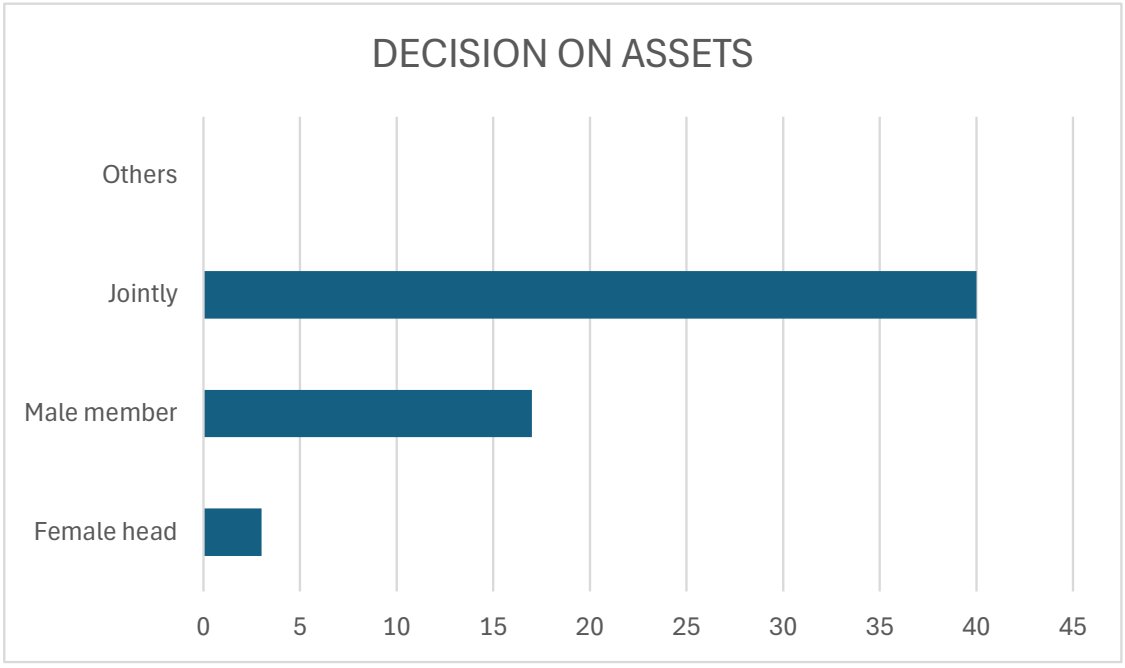
Table 4.24

Decision on purchasing assts

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Female head	3	5%
Male member	17	28.3%
Jointly	40	67%
Others	0	0%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.22



INTERPRETATION: 67% household make joint decision ,28.3% by male member,5% by male member and0% by others.

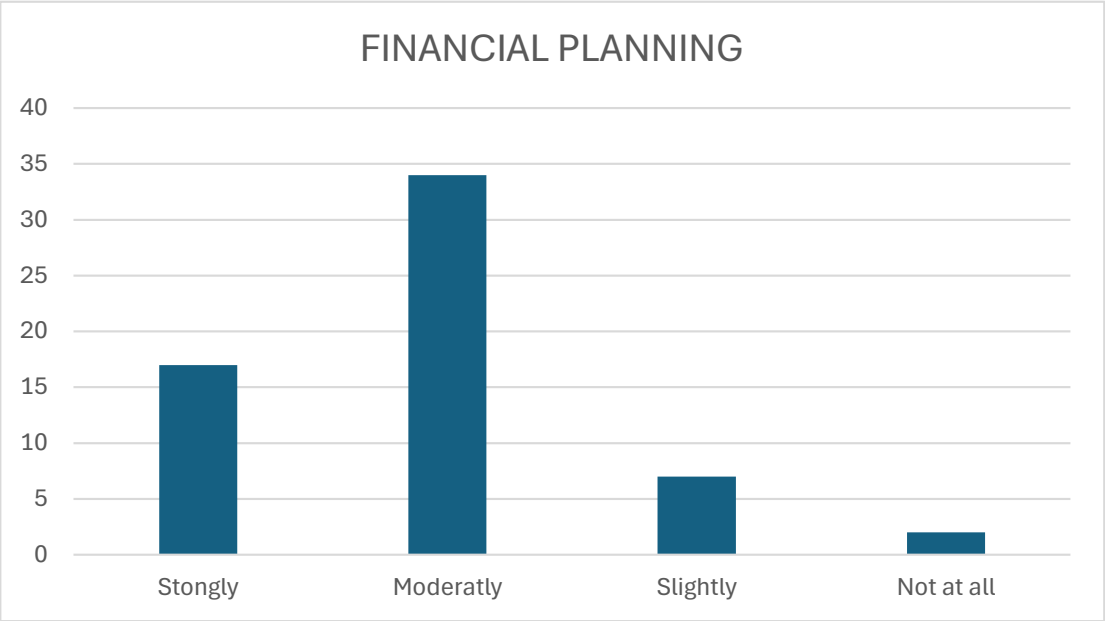
Table 4.25

Influence long term financial planning

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Strongly	17	28.3%
Moderately	34	57%
Slightly	7	12%
Not at all	2	3.3%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.23



INTERPRETATION: 57% have moderate influence on financial planning, 28.3% have strong influence,12% have slightly,3.3% have not at all.

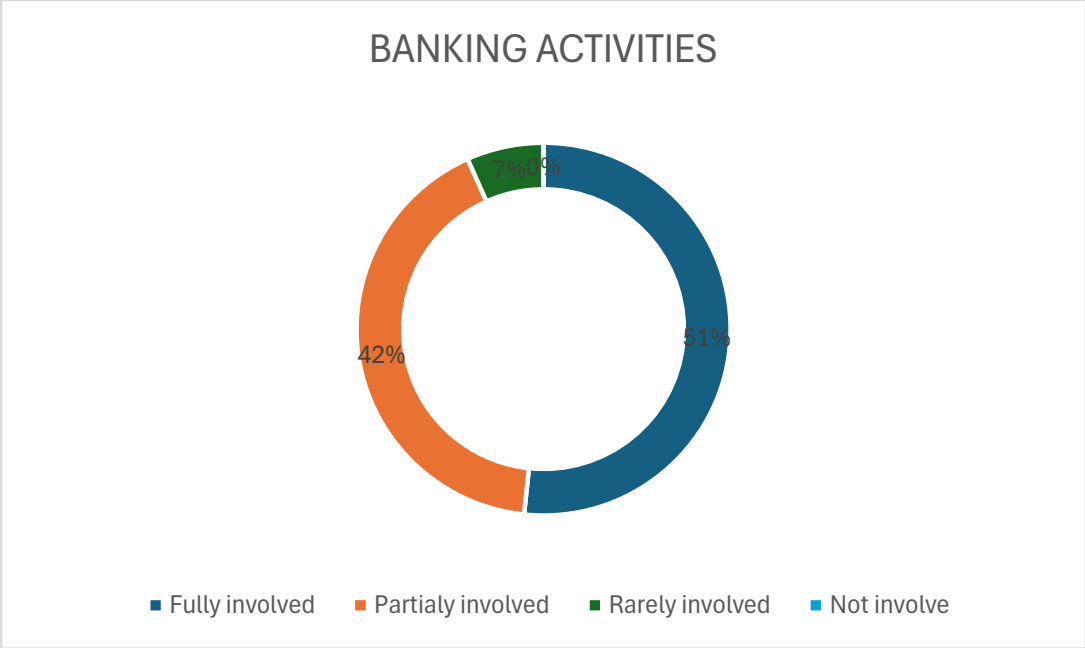
Table 4.26

Involvement in banking activities

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Fully involved	31	57%
Partially involved	25	42%
Rarely involved	4	7%
Not involve	0	0%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source; primary data

Figure 4.24



INTERPRETATION: 57% female head fully involved in banking activities,42% are partially,7% are rarely and 0% are not involved.

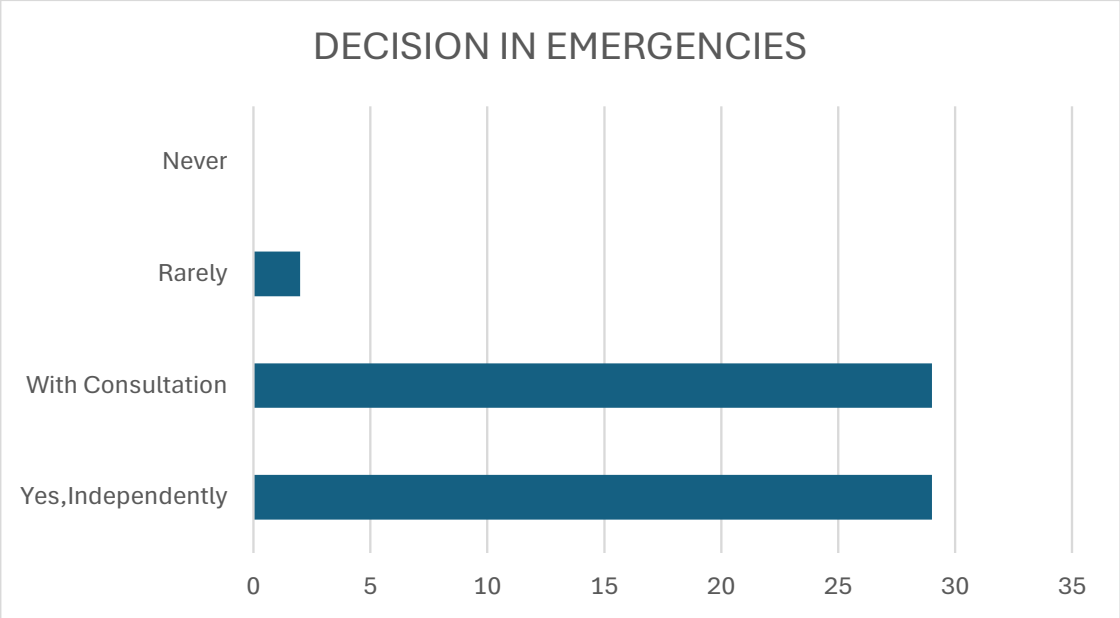
Table 4.27

Independent financial decision in emergencies

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Yes, independently	29	48.3%
With consultation	29	48.3%
Rarely	2	3.3%
Never	0	0%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.25



INTERPRETATION: 48.3% make decision independently and with consultation,3.3% are rarely and 0% never.

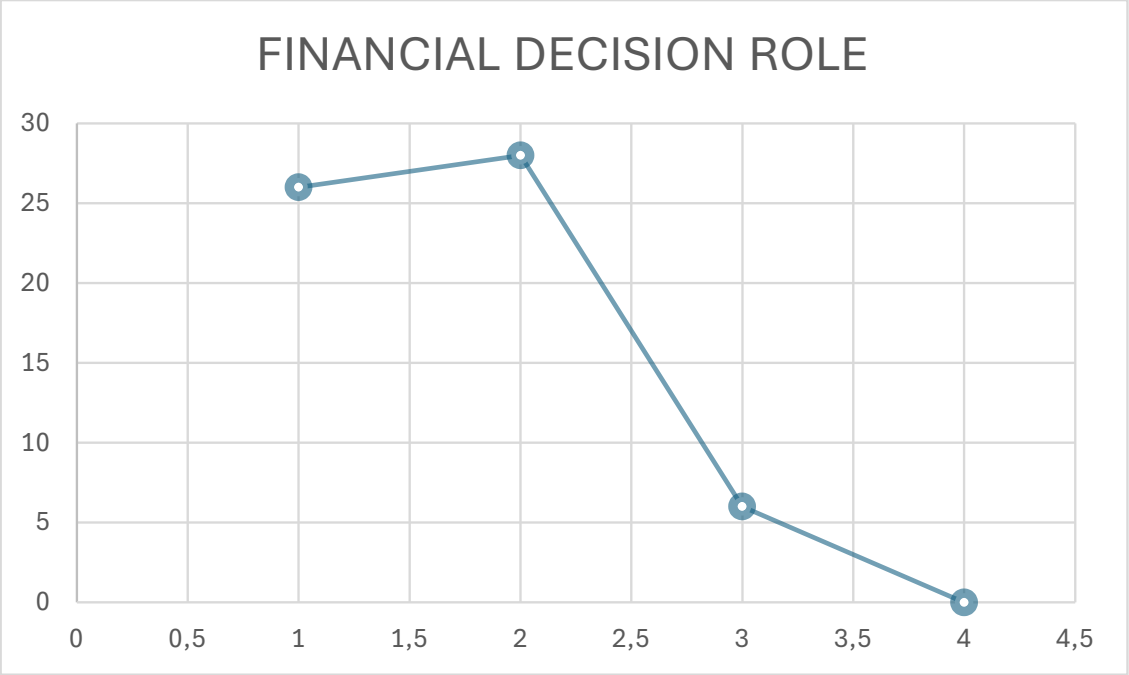
Table 4.28

Financial decision role of female head

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Very Strong	26	43.3%
Moderate	28	47%
Limited	6	10%
Very Limited	0	0%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.26



INTERPRETATION:47% of female head have moderate decision role,43.3% have very strong role,10% have limited role and 0% have very limited role.

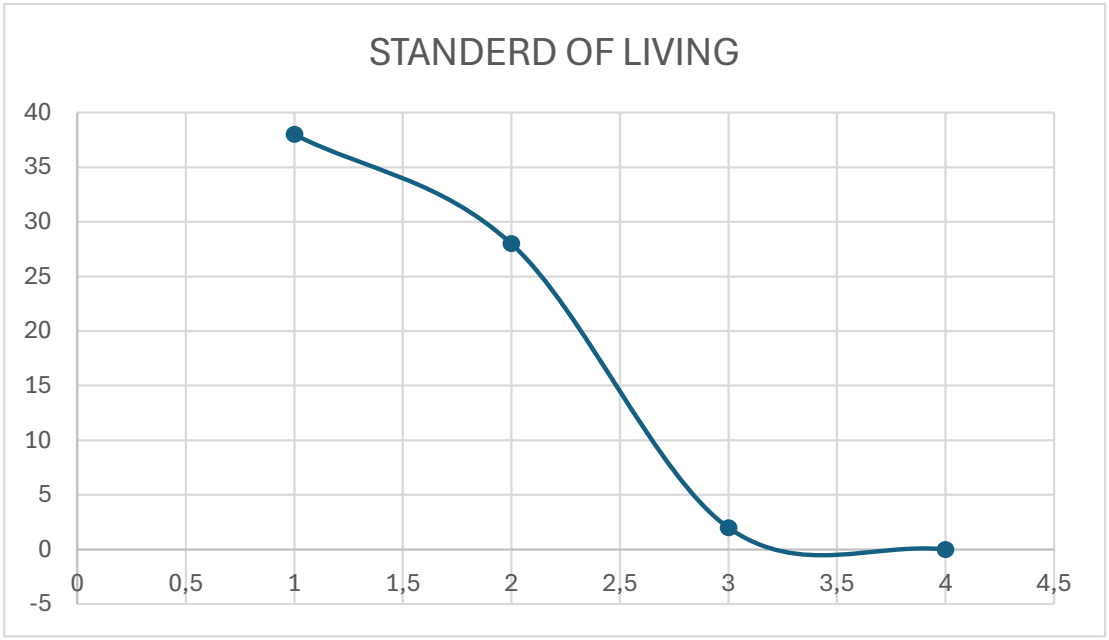
Table 4.29

Standard of Living

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Significantly	38	63.3%
Moderately	28	47%
Slightly	2	3.3%
Not at all	0	0%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.27



INTERPRETATION:63.3% respondents ststed standerd of living improved significantly,47% felt in improved moderatly,3.3% reported slight improvement and 0% reported no improvement.

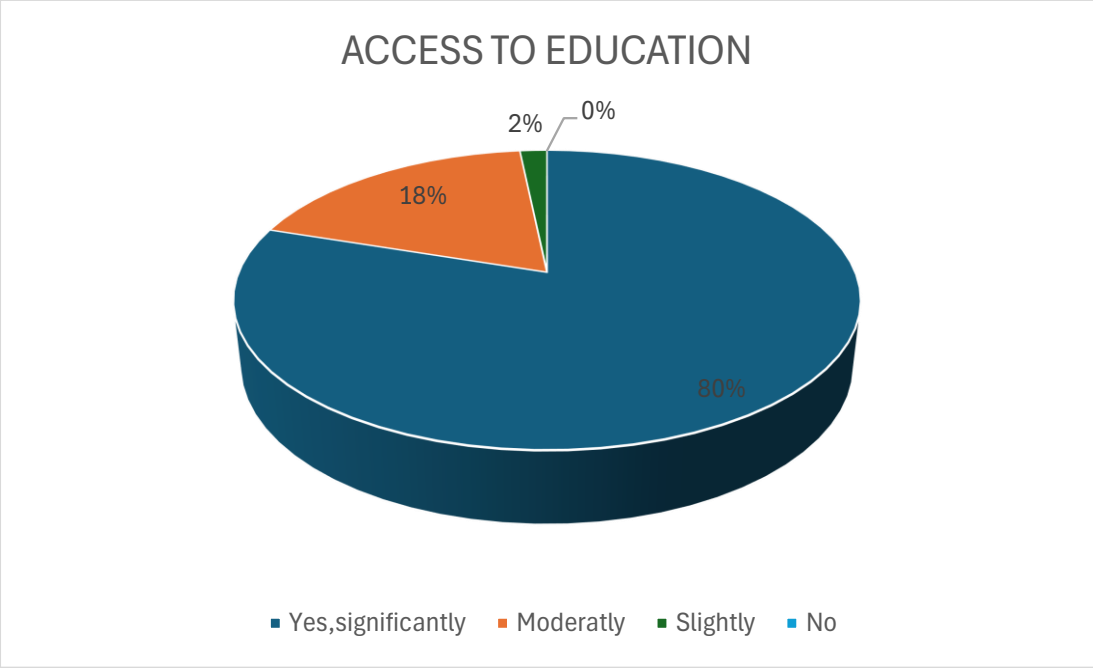
Table 4.30

Improvement in acces to better education

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Yes, significantly	48	80%
Moderately	11	18.3%
Slightly	1	2%
No	0	0%
Total	**60**	**100%**

Source: primary data

Figure 4.28



INTERPRETATION:80% have significant improvement ,18.3% have moderate improvement,2% have slight improvement and 0% indicating inimprovement.

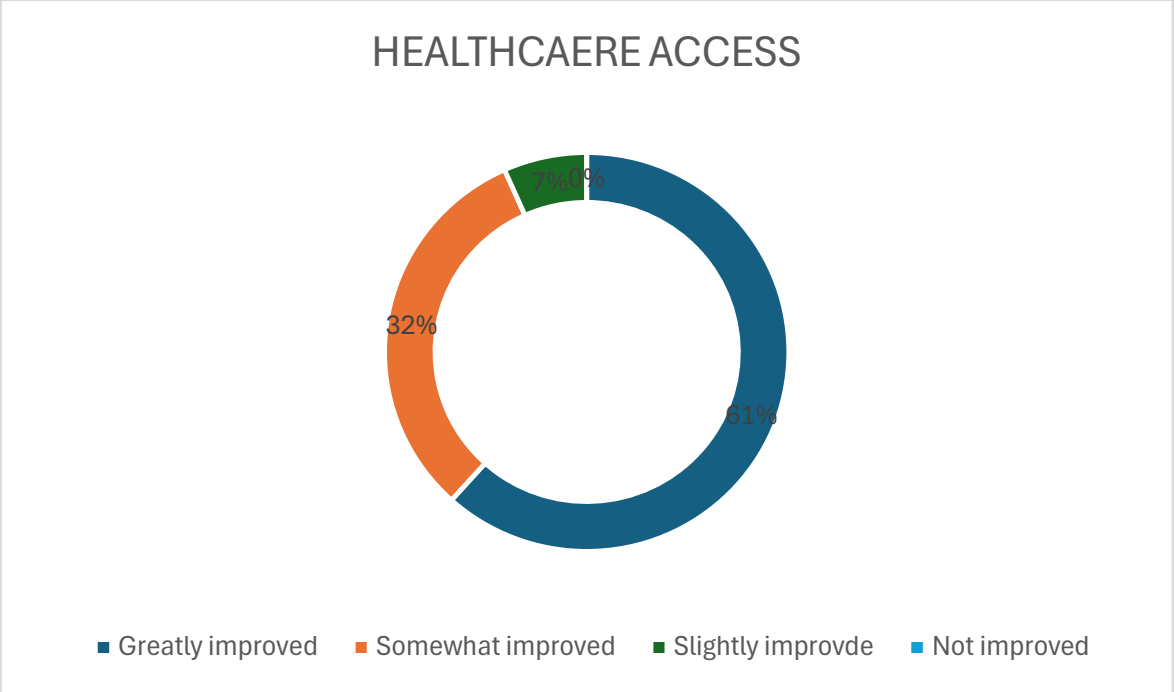
Table 4.31

Improvement in healthcare access

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Greatly improved	37	62%
Somewhat improved	19	32%
Slightly improved	4	7%
Not improved	0	0%
Total	60	100%

Source:primary data

Figure 4.29



INTERPRETATION: 62% of respondents reported health care access improved greatly, 32% reported somewhat improved, 7% reported slight improvement and 0% reported not improvement.

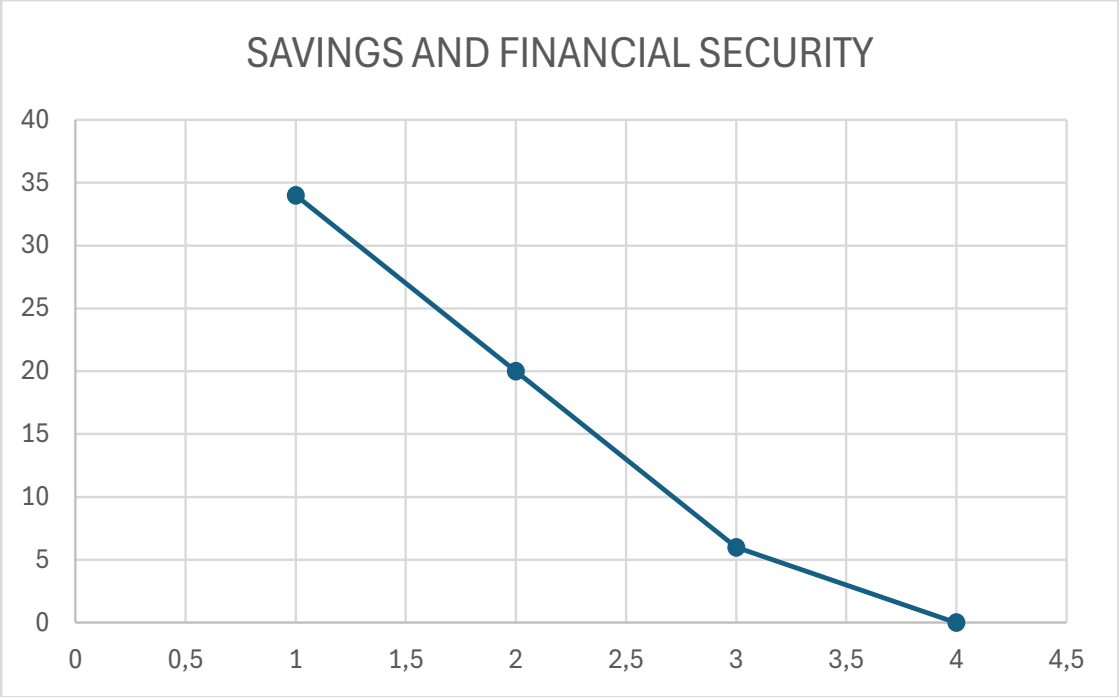
Table 4.32

Increased savings and financial security

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Strongly improved	34	57%
Moderately increased	20	33.3%
Slightly increased	6	10%
Not increased	0	0%
Total	60	100%

Source: primary data

Figure 4.30



INTERPRETATION: 57% of respondents reported strongly increased,33.3% reported moderately increased, 10% reported slightly increased and 0% are not increased.

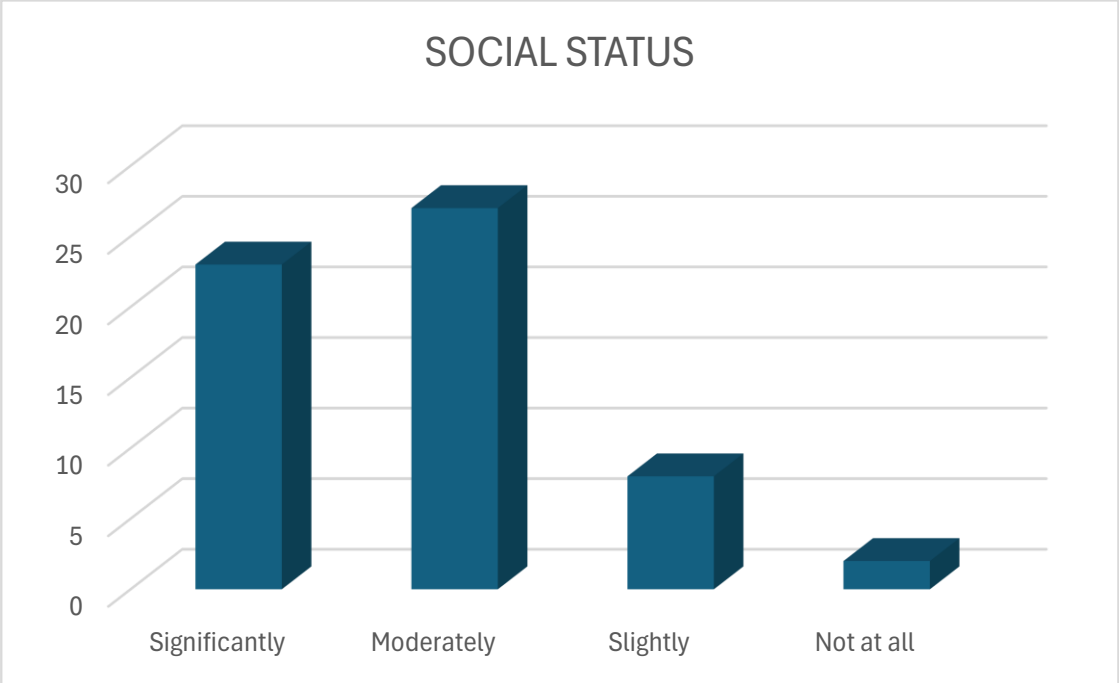
Table 4.33

Improvement in social status

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Significantly	23	38.3%
Moderately	27	45%
Slightly	8	13.3%
Not at all	2	3.3%
Total	60	100%

Source: primary data

Figure 4.31



INTERPRETATION: 45% of respondents reported moderate improvement in social status, 38.3% reported significantly, 13.3% reported slightly and 3.35 reported not at all.

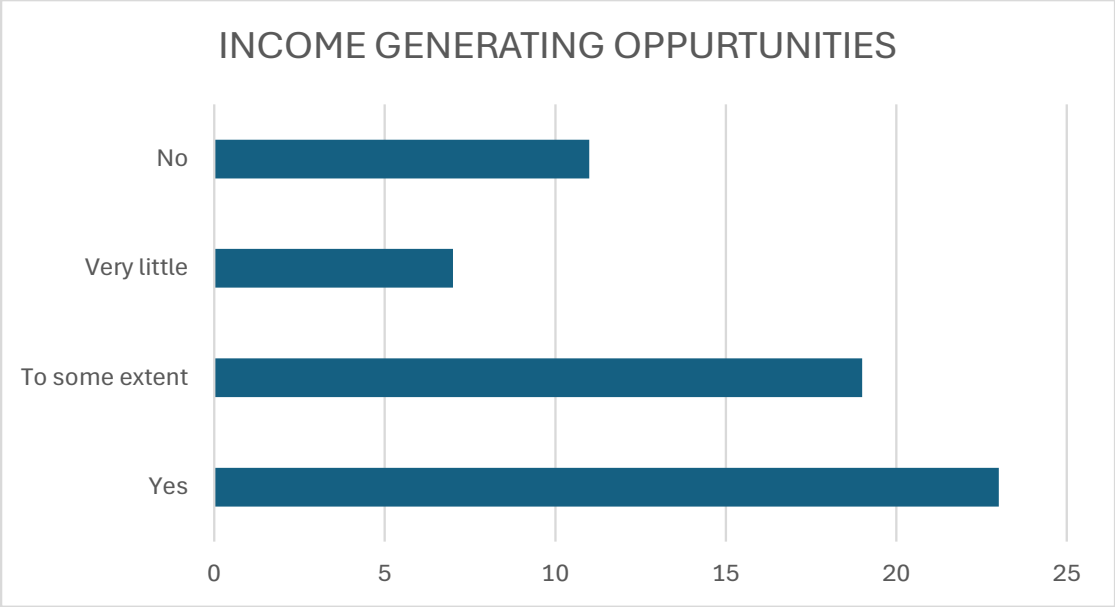
Table 4.34

New income generating opportunities

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Yes	23	38.3%
To some extent	19	32%
Very little	7	12%
No	11	18.3%
Total	60	100%

Source: primary data

Figure 4.32



INTERPRETATION: 38.3% of respondents reported remittance generated income generating opportunities, 32% reported to some extent, 18.3% reported nothing created and 12% reported very little.

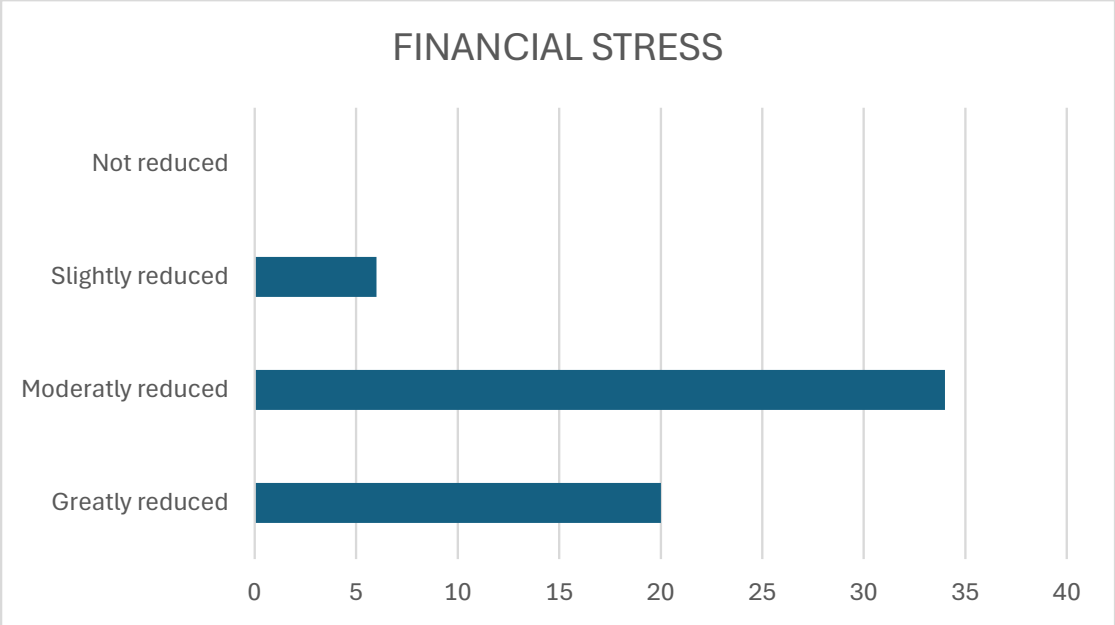
Table 4.35

Reduced financial stress

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Greatly reduced	20	33.3%
Moderately reduced	34	57%
Slightly reduced	6	10%
Not reduced	0	0%
Total	60	100%

Source: primary data

Figure 4.33



INTERPRETATION: 57% of respondents reported financial stress reduced moderately, 33.3% reported greatly reduced, 10% reported slightly reduced and 0% reported not reduced.

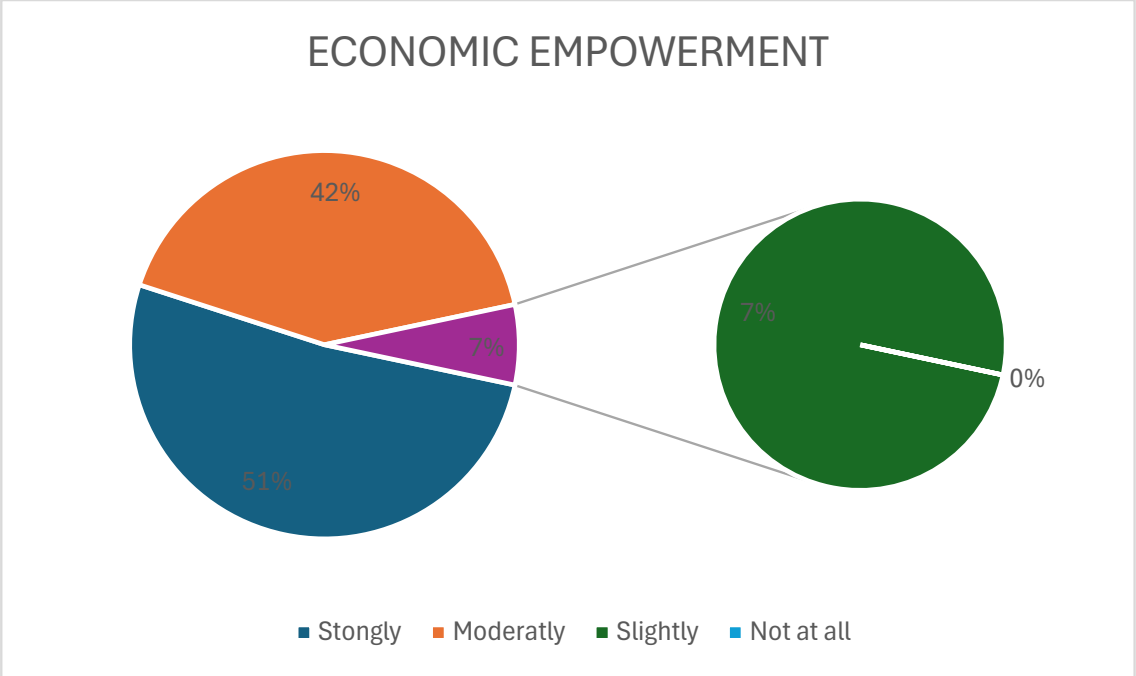
Table 4.36

Women's economic empowerment

Heads	No. of respondents	Percentage
Strongly	31	51%
Moderately	25	42%
Slightly	4	7%
Not at all	0	0%
Total	60	100%

Source: primary data

Figure 4.34



INTERPRETATION: 52% of respondents reported strong improvement ,42% reported moderately,7% reported slightly and 0% reported not at all.

Table 4.37

Socio-economic impact of remittance

Categories	No. of respondents	Percentage
Very positive	24	40%
Positive	32	53.3%
Neutral	4	7%
No	0	0%
Total	60	100%

Source: primary data

Figure 4.35



INTERPRETATION: 53.3% of respondents rated remittance income have positive impact, 40% rated very positive, 7% rated neutral and 0% rated no impact.

CHAPTER V

FINDINGS, SUGGESTIONS AND CONCLUSION

FINDINGS, SUGGESTIONS

AND CONCLUSION

5.1 Findings

- The study was conducted among 60 respondents belonging to different age groups, with most respondents concentrated in the below 30, 31–40, and 41–50 age categories.
- Most respondents received remittances ranging between ₹1 lakh and ₹3 lakh annually, while a smaller number received amounts above ₹5 lakh.
- The majority of remittances originated from GCC countries, indicating the significant role of Gulf migration in household income.
- All respondents reported using remittance income for daily household expenses, showing that remittances are primarily utilized for meeting basic family needs.
- A large number of respondents consistently used remittance income for children's education.
- Remittance income was commonly utilized for healthcare expenses.
- Most respondents reported saving a portion of their remittance income regularly.
- Bank deposits emerged as the most preferred savings option among respondents.
- Only a limited number of respondents were involved in small businesses, although several expressed plans to start one in the future.
- The majority of respondents were not engaged in any form of business or self-employment activity.
- Many households used remittance income for house construction or renovation.
- Remittance income contributed to debt repayment among households.
- Most respondents experienced improvement in household consumption due to remittance income.
- Asset purchases were made occasionally by many respondents.
- Remittances were frequently utilized for social and family functions.
- Respondents generally believed that remittance income was utilized effectively within their households.
- Financial decisions in households were predominantly made jointly by family members.
- Female heads played an important role in deciding how remittance income was spent.

- Decisions regarding household investments were mainly taken jointly by family members.
- Household savings management was largely a shared responsibility between family members.
- Female heads were actively involved in preparing household budgets.
- Decisions concerning children's education were mostly made jointly by both parents.
- Borrowing-related decisions were generally taken through joint consultation within the household.
- Asset purchase decisions were also largely made jointly by family members.
- Female heads had a noticeable influence on long-term financial planning within the household.
- Many female heads were actively involved in banking activities and financial transactions.
- During emergencies, respondents either made financial decisions independently or after consultation with family members.
- Female heads were perceived to have a strong role in household financial decision-making.
- Respondents reported improvements in their overall standard of living due to remittance income.
- Remittances contributed to better educational opportunities for family members.
- Access to healthcare services improved for many households because of remittance income.
- Savings levels and financial security improved among respondents receiving remittances.
- Respondents observed positive changes in their social status and community standing.
- Remittances created opportunities for additional income-generating activities for some households.
- Financial stress was reduced among most respondents due to the regular flow of remittance income.
- Remittance income contributed positively to women's economic empowerment and financial participation.
- Overall, respondents viewed remittances as having a positive socio-economic impact on their households and quality of life.

5.2 Suggestions

The role of women as financial decision-makers in households has gained increasing importance, especially in the context of foreign remittances. In regions like Sulthan Bathery Taluk, where remittances form a significant part of household income, women often manage and allocate these funds. However, despite their crucial role, many women face challenges such as limited financial literacy, restricted decision-making power, and lack of access to formal financial services. Strengthening their capacity as financial architects can lead to better utilization of remittances, improved household welfare, and sustainable economic development. Therefore, focused measures are required to empower women in effectively managing remittance income.

- Enhance Financial Literacy:
  Provide targeted financial education programs for women to improve their knowledge in budgeting, saving, investment, and risk management.
- Promote Access to Banking Services:
  Encourage women to open and actively use bank accounts, digital payment systems, and other formal financial institutions to ensure secure and efficient handling of remittances.
- Encourage Investment-Oriented Utilisation:
  Motivate households to channel remittance income into productive investments such as small businesses, education, agriculture, and asset creation rather than only consumption.
- Strengthen Decision-Making Power:
  Promote gender equality within households by encouraging joint financial decision-making and recognizing women's role in financial planning.
- Provide Skill Development and Entrepreneurship Training:
  Offer training programs that enable women to start and manage income-generating activities, enhancing the long-term impact of remittance funds.
- Improve Access to Credit Facilities:
  Facilitate easy access to microfinance and credit institutions for women to support entrepreneurial activities and financial independence.

- Promote Awareness of Government Schemes:
  Increase awareness about government welfare programs, savings schemes, and investment opportunities that can help in better financial planning.
- Encourage Savings and Insurance Practices:
  Promote regular saving habits and the use of insurance products to ensure financial security and risk protection for households.
- Support Community-Based Financial Groups:
  Encourage participation in self-help groups (SHGs) and women's cooperatives to enhance collective financial management and mutual support.

5.3 Conclusion

In conclusion, women-headed households in Sulthan Bathery taluk play a significant role in shaping the effective utilization of foreign remittances. Their active involvement in financial decision-making leads to better allocation of resources toward savings, education, healthcare, and productive investments, thereby improving the overall standard of living. However, the optimal use of remittances depends on enhancing women's financial literacy, expanding their access to formal banking and financial services, and encouraging entrepreneurial activities. Support from government agencies, financial institutions, and community organizations is essential to provide training, credit facilities, and guidance for sustainable income generation. Moreover, reducing excessive dependence on remittances by promoting diversified income sources can strengthen economic resilience. By empowering women with knowledge, resources, and decision-making authority, remittance income can be transformed into a powerful tool for long-term development. Thus, recognizing and supporting women as financial architects is crucial not only for household prosperity but also for fostering inclusive and sustainable regional economic growth.

BIBLIOGRAPHY

- Abokyi, Eric (2023)," *Effects of Remittances on Financial Inclusion Gender Gap in Developing Countries"* Research In Economics,1-24.
- Asian Development Bank (ADB) & World Bank (2018), "*Migration and Remittances for Development in Asia"* Asian Development Bank and the World Ban,1-80.
- A. S. Oberai and H. K. Manmohan Singh (1980), "*Migration, Remittances and Rural Development: Findings of a Case Study in the Indian Punjab"* International Labour Office (ILO) / Macmillan, 229–241.
- Chinmay Tumbe(2019), " *Remittances in India Facts and Issues"* Munich Personal RePEc Archive (MPRA),1-32.
- Dilip Ratha (2005), "*Workers' Remittances: An Important and Stable Source of External Development Finance"* Global Development Finance publications, 19–35.
- Dr. Sunitha Kumari and Chandra Shekhar Dwivedi (2021),"*Migrant Women and Geography of Remittance"* National Geographical Society of India, 397–409.
- Hristos Doucouliagos and Zohid Askarov (2020), "*A Meta-Analysis of the Effects of Remittances on Household Education expenditure"* World Development, 1–18.
- Hyderali. K,Amina Poovancheri and Sandhya KP (2025), "*Trends and Patterns of Migration Remittances in Kerala*: An Insight from Kerala Migration Survey" Asian Journal of Economics, Business and Accounting,567–576.
- International Organization for Migration (2010), *"Gender, Migration and Remittances"* IOM (UN Migration Agency,1-21.
- Jo Joseph (2023), "*The Impact of Migrant Remittances In India"* Social Science Research Network,1-15.
- J. Hennebry, J. Holliday and M. Monniruzzaman (2016) ," *At what cost? Women migrant workers, remittances and development"* UN Women / International Organization for Migration (IOM),1-64.
- K P Kannan and K S Hari (2002), "*Kerala's Gulf connection: Emigration, remittances and their macroeconomic impact 1972-2000"* Centre for Development Studies,145.

- Kristin Gobel (2013), "Remittances, Expenditure Patterns, and Gender: Parametric and Semiparametric Evidence from Ecuador" Journal of Global Positioning Systems / IZA Journal of Development and Migration,1-21.
- Lakhwinder Singh (2015), *" International Migration Remittances and Resource Allocation in the Rural Households of Punjab"* Punjabi University, 1–28.
- Lian Kwen Fee and Md Mizanur Rahman (2009), *" Gender and the Remittances Process"* UNIFEM, 1–38.
- Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (2016),"*The Impact of Remittance in Migrant Workers on their Families and Local Economy Development in Odisha"* Government of India,1-110.
- Michael Kollmair, Bhim Prasad Subedi and Susan Theim (2006), "*New Figures for Old Stories: Migration and Remittances in Nepal"* Migration Letters, 151–160.
- Ruksana M.M and Dr.Gangadharan (2016), "*Remittances and Quality of Life of Emigrant Families in Kerala"* International Journal of Research in Social Sciences, 344–358.
- Sancy K Jose (2022),"*Female Headed Households Spend Less and Save More in Kerala"* Modern Diplomacy, 1-5.
- Samrat Sarkar and Reshmi R. S (2024),"*Delving the Influence of Socio-Economic, Demographic and Migration Factors on Utilisation of Remittances in the Agricultural Sector in a High out-migrating Region in India"* Research in Globalization, 1–14.
- Sarina Jain (2015), "*Remittances: A Tool for Women's Economic Empowerment"* Gokhale Institute of Politics and Economics / JNU research prints, 1–18.
- Salim Raiham, Mahthad Uddin and Sakil Ahmmed(2020), "*Impact of Foreign Remittances on the Household Spending Behaviour in Bangladesh"* Economic and Social Development of Bangladesh,183–204.
- Seemarani Meher and Lopamudra Mishra (2025), "*The Impact of Remittances Sent to India (1980-2021) on Economic Growth and Capital Formation: An Econometric Case Study"* South Asian Journal of Social Studies and Economics, 45-59.
- Surendra Basnet (2024), "*Understanding Expenditure Patterns of Remittance Receiving Households in Dhading, Nepal: A Mixed-Methods Study"* Liverpool John Moores University (LJMU) Research Online, UK,1-245.

- Sharon H Green (2019), "*Patterned Remittances Enhance Women's Health-Related Autonomy"* University of Michigan / Harvard Dataverse repositories,1-21.
- Tamanna Islam, Md. Abdul Ahad ,Dr. Mitu Chowdhury and Tanvir Ahmed (2018),"*Role of Women in Remittance-earning Households: Evidence from Sylhet City, Bangladesh"* Asian Research Journal of Arts & Social Sciences, 1–10.
- UNCDF (2024)," *Bridging the Digital Divide: Gender Insights on Remittance Access, Usage, and Financial Health"* the United Nations Capital Development Fund,1-35.
- WORLD BANK GROUP (2021), *"Women and Remittances: Three takeaways from Project Greenback in the Western Balkans"* World Bank Group,1-8.
- https://www.journalajeba.com/index.php/AJEBA/article/view/1824/4034
- https://share.google/kbKwxLohSSLUkduIw5
- https://share.google/LcnGl8wVcI2cJ3iwR
- https://link.springer.com/article/10.1186/2193-9039-2-1
- https://share.google/9jmz1s0Rin76hz5Yi
- (https://share.google/83k7TKzobchKCSpWS).
- https://www.journalajeba.com/index.php/AJEBA/article/view/1824/4034
- https://share.google/sgoRxxYgAqMIZ2m).

APPENDIX

1.Name?

2. What is your age group?

□Below 30 □ 31–40

□41to 50 □above 50

3.What is the approximate annual amount of remittance received?

□Below 1lakh □ 1 lakh –3 lakh

□3lakh –5 lakh □ Above ₹5 lakh

4.From which region do you receive remittances?

□GCC countries □Other Asian countries

□Europe □Others

5.How is the major portion of remittance income usually spent?

□Daily household expenses □Entertainment

□Luxury goods □Foreign travel

6. Is remittance income used for children's education?

□Always □ Sometimes

□ Rarely □Never

7.Do female-headed households use remittance money for healthcare expenses?

□Frequently □Occasionally

□Very rarely □Not at all

8.Is any part of remittance income saved regularly?

□Yes, regularly □ Yes, occasionally

□Rarely □ Never

9. How is remittance income mainly saved?

□ Bank deposits □ Gold purchase

□ Chit funds □Not saved

10.Is remittance income invested in small businesses or self-employment?

□Yes □No

□ Planning to invest □ Not interested

11.if yes specify?

12. Is remittance income used to repay debts?

□Major portion □Minor portion

□Very little □ Not used

13.Does remittance income improve household consumption standards?

□Significantly □Moderately

□Slightly □Not at all

14.Is remittance money used for purchasing assets (land, vehicle, etc.)?

□Frequently □Occasionally

□Rarely □ Never

15.Is remittance income used for social functions (marriage, festivals)?

□ Often □Sometimes

□ Rarely □ Never

16.Overall, how effectively is remittance income utilized?

□ Very effectively □ Moderately effectively

□ Slightly effectively □ Ineffectively

17.Who mainly makes financial decisions in your household?

□ Female head □ Male member

□ Joint decision □ Other family member

18.Does the female head decide how remittance income is spent?

□Always □Often

□Sometimes □ Never

19.Who decides about major household investments?

□ Female head □Male member

□Jointly □ Relatives

20.Who manages household savings?

□ Female head □ Male member

□ Jointly □ No formal management

21.Does the female head prepare a household budget?

□Regularly □ Occasionally

□Rarely □ Never

22.Who decides about children's education expenses?

□ Female head □ Male member

□ Jointly □Elders

23. Does the female head make decisions regarding borrowing or loans?

□Independently □ Jointly

□ With consultation □ Not involved

24.Who decides about purchasing assets (land, gold, vehicle)?

□ Female head □Male member

□ Jointly □Others

25.Does the female head influence long-term financial planning?

□ Strongly □Moderately

□Slightly □Not at all

26. Is the female head involved in banking activities?

□Fully involved □Partially involved

□Rarely involved □Not involved

27.Does the female head take independent financial decisions in emergencies?

□Yes, independently □ With consultation

□ Rarely □ Never

28. Overall, how would you rate the financial decision-making role of the female head?

□ Very strong □Moderate

□ Limited □Very limited

29.Has remittance income improved your family's standard of living?

□ Significantly □ Moderately

□ Slightly □ Not at all

30.Has remittance income improved access to better education?

□Yes, significantly □ Moderately

□Slightly □No

31.Has healthcare access improved due to remittance income?

□ Greatly improved □Somewhat improved

□Slightly improved □Not improved

32.Has your family constructed or renovated a house using remittance income?

□ Yes, fully □ Partly

□ Planning □No

33.Has remittance income increased savings and financial security?

□ Strongly increased □Moderately increased

□Slightly increased □Not increased

34.Has remittance income improved social status in the community?

□ Significantly □ Moderately

□ Slightly □ Not at all

35.Has remittance income created new income-generating opportunities?

□ Yes □ To some extent

□Very little □ No

36.Has remittance income reduced financial stress in the family?

□ Greatly reduced □ Moderately reduced

□ Slightly reduced □Not reduced

37. Has remittance income improved women's economic empowerment?

□ Strongly □Moderately

□ Slightly □ Not at all

38.Overall, how would you rate the socio-economic impact of remittance income?

□Very positive □Positive

□ Neutral □ Negative